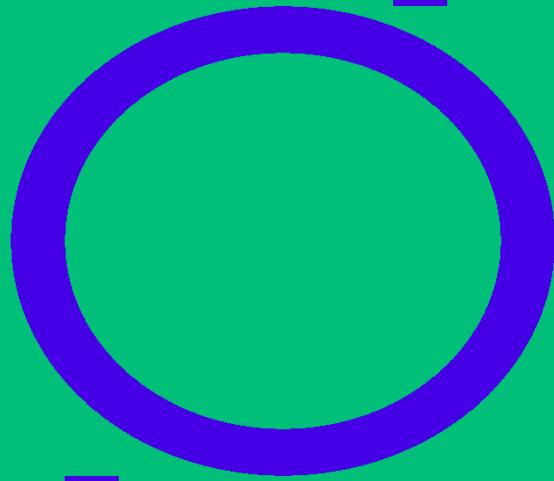


The white doe

the fate of Virginia Dare, an Indian legend

Sallie Southall Cotten

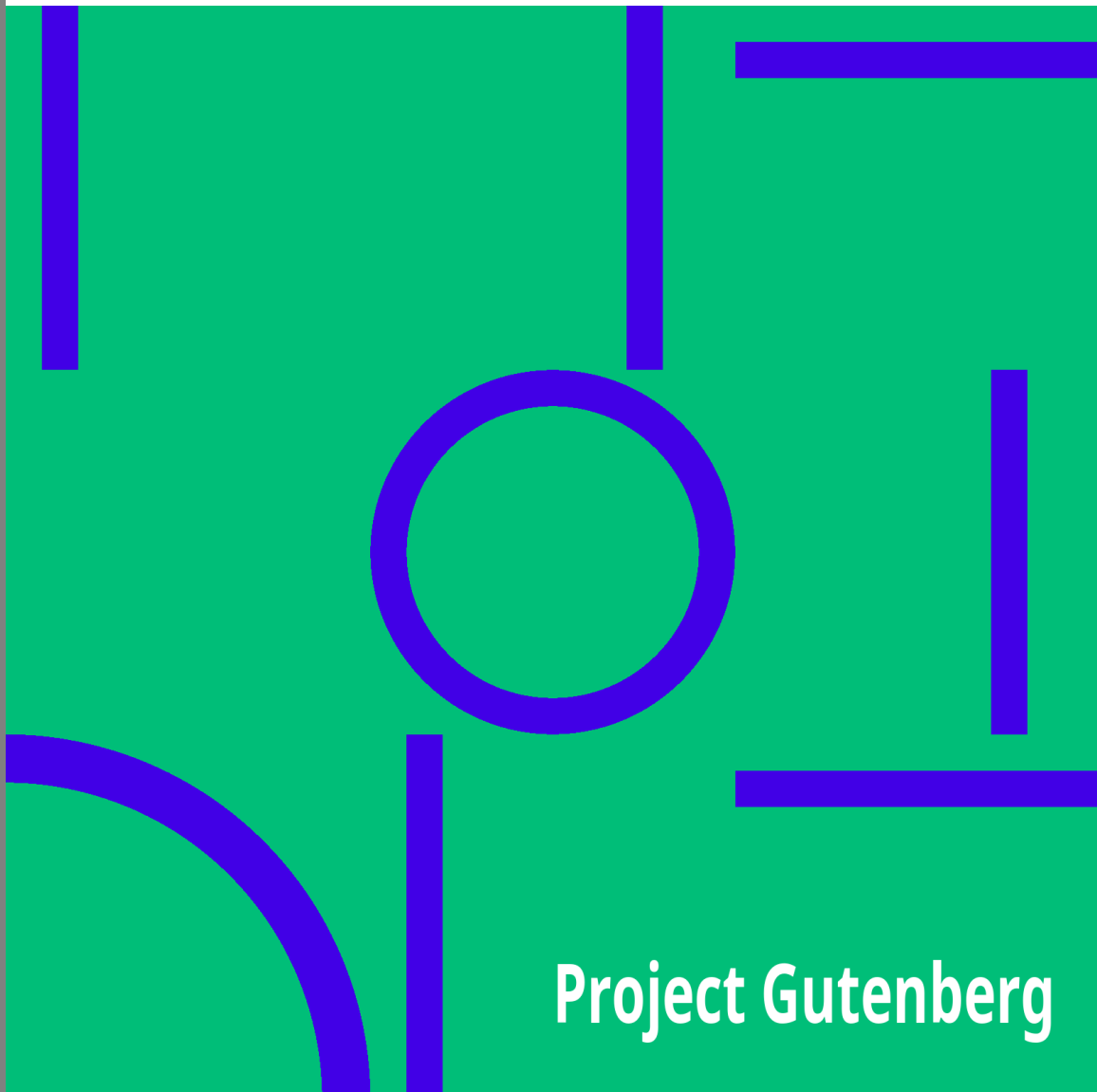


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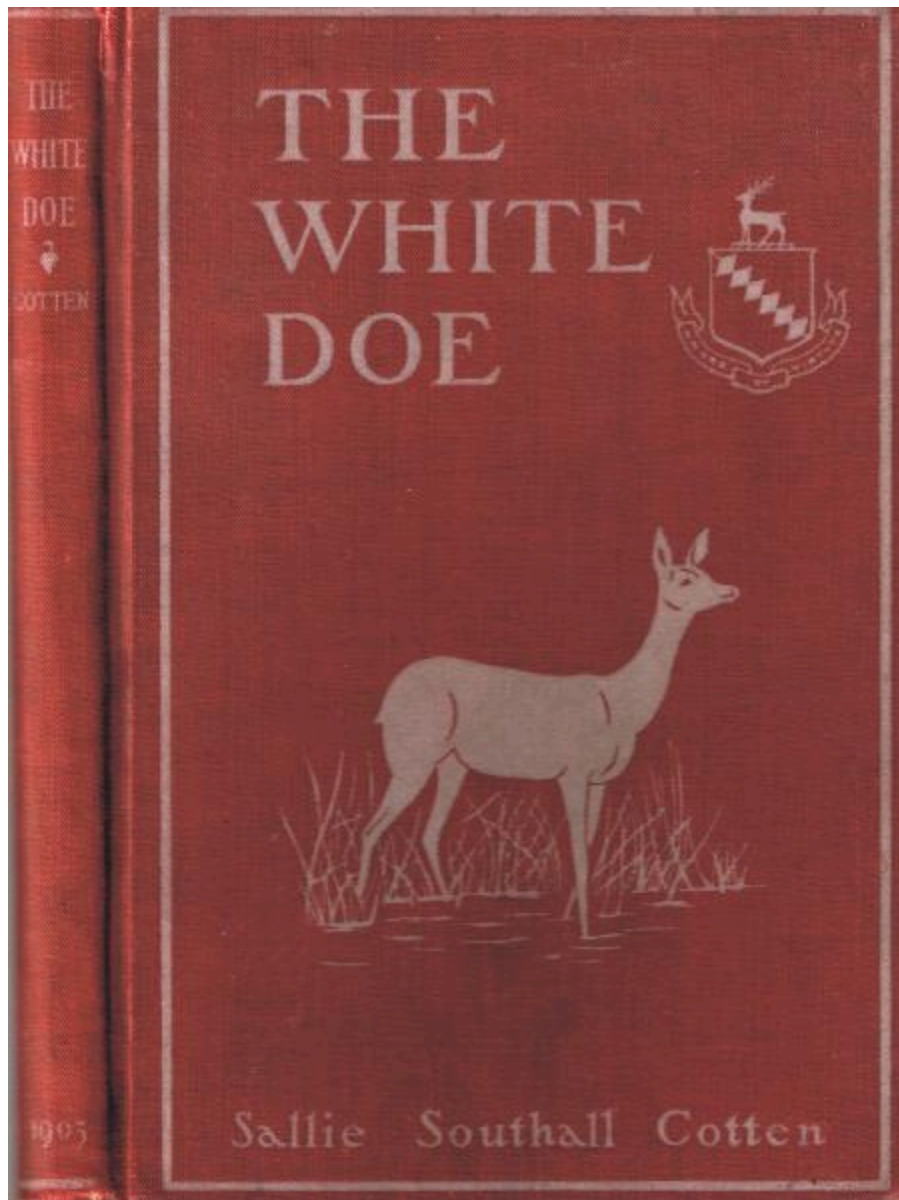
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DOE ***



THE WHITE DOE

THE FATE OF VIRGINIA DARE

AN INDIAN LEGEND

BY

SALLIE
SOUTHALL
COTTEN



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**"While within its bright'ning dimness,
With the misty halo 'round her,
Stood a beautiful white maiden" Page [70](#)**

TO

The National Society
of

Colonial Dames of America

WHOSE PATRIOTIC WORK HAS STIMULATED
RESEARCH INTO AN IMPORTANT AND
INTERESTING PERIOD OF THE HISTORY OF

OUR BELOVED COUNTRY

FORGOTTEN FACTS AND FANCIES OF AMERICAN HISTORY



As civilization advances there develops in the heart of man a higher appreciation of the past, and the deeds of preceding generations come to be viewed with a calm criticism which denudes those deeds of false splendor and increases the lustre of real accomplishment. Man cannot see into the future and acquire the prescience of coming events which would make him infallible, but he can remove the veil from the past, contemplate the mistakes and successes of those who have lived before him, and who struggled with the same problems which now confront him. The results of their efforts are recorded in history, and inspired by high ideals he can study the past, and by feeding his lamp of wisdom with the oil of their experiences he secures a greater light to guide his own activities. Man remains a slave to Fate until Knowledge makes him free, and while all true knowledge comes from experience, it need not necessarily be *personal* experience.

In studying the past, deeds come to be estimated more with reference to their ultimate results and as factors in universal progress, and less as personal efforts; just as more and more the personal merges into the universal in all lines of endeavor. Viewed in this light of ultimate results an imperishable and increased lustre envelops the name of Sir Walter Raleigh as the pioneer and faithful promoter of English colonization in America. The recognition of his services by the people who reap the reward of his labors has ever been too meagre. A portrait here and there, the name of the capital city in a State, a mention among other explorers on a tablet in the National Library, the name of a battleship, and a few pages in history, help to remind us of his association with this nation. Perhaps a few may recognize his personal colors—red and white—in the binding in this book, and his Coat of Arms in the heraldic device which ornaments the cover, and which are mentioned "lest we forget" one we should honor.

The present and ever increasing greatness of these United States is due to the efforts of this remarkable man, who so wondrously combined in one personality the attributes of statesman, courtier, soldier, scientist, poet, explorer, and martyr. Isabella of Spain offered her jewels to aid Columbus, and the deed has been lauded and celebrated as of international value, yet it contained no touch of personal sacrifice. She was never deprived of her jewels, and while her generous offer proved her faith in the theories and ability of Columbus, it brought to her no suffering. On the other hand, the efforts of Sir Walter Raleigh were at his own expense, and entailed financial disaster on him in the end. That he sought to extend the power of England must be admitted by those who correctly estimate his character; yet no one will deny that he was the most important factor in the colonization of America by the English. Spain, France, and England contended long for supremacy in the New World, but France failed to gain any permanent power, and Spanish dominance, as illustrated in South America and Mexico, was followed by slow progress. It was the English race, *led by Raleigh*, which has become the leading power and modern strength of America. Colony after colony he sent to the new land, and desisted not, even after the death of his half-brother and coadjutor, Sir Humphrey Gilbert. Disaster could not daunt so brave a spirit, and with unsurpassed enterprise and perseverance he continued to send expeditions year after year to what is now the coast of North Carolina, but which was then called Virginia, and recognized as Raleigh's possessions. Much money was required, and when his own fortune was exhausted he transferred to what is known as the London Company his rights to the land, and *by his advice* they avoided his mistakes and made the next settlement at Jamestown instead of Roanoke Island.

These facts have been temporarily obscured by the moss of neglect, but they cannot be destroyed. They will ever remain the foundation-stones of the great structure known and respected among nations as the United States of America, and were laid by Sir Walter Raleigh at Roanoke Island, on the coast of North Carolina, which was then called Virginia. The intervening years have brought great results, those early struggles have ripened into success and greatness beyond Raleigh's most sanguine dreams. A new race has arisen, yet bearing the characteristics of the race from which it sprung. Our English ancestors, our heritage of English law and custom, of religion

and home life, of language and ideals, all tempered by the development of new characteristics, bind us *through him* to England.

Sir Walter Raleigh was not an ordinary man. He was one of the most remarkable of a coterie of remarkable men whom a remarkable queen (Elizabeth) gathered around her, and to whom she owed much of the grandeur of her remarkable reign. Elizabeth's greatest gift was a capacity for discerning and using great minds, and she had the good fortune to find many around her at that period of time. Raleigh won her favor, and received from her many benefits, among which was the honor of knighthood with its emoluments, which she conferred. In the end her favor cost him dear, because his heart had the courage to be true to itself in love. Elizabeth never forgave him for loving, marrying, and being true until death to her maid of honor, the beautiful Elizabeth Throckmorton. That vain and jealous queen permitted no rivals, and she wished to reign over the heart of this man, who, handsome, brave, gallant, intelligent, and romantic, made an ideal courtier. His life at court was brilliant but brief. Love anchored a soul attuned to loftier deeds, and after his marriage his career as a courtier was eclipsed by his later exploits as a statesman, warrior, explorer, and author. He planned and participated in many expeditions which brought benefit to his queen and added to his own fortune, yet none of his expeditions have borne such an ever-increasing harvest of results as those he sent to America. He began that work in 1584, and continued to send expeditions in 1585-1586-1587, until the invasion of England by the Spanish Armada forced him to other activities, and even then he sent two expeditions to the relief of the colonists, which, because of the exigencies of war, failed to reach America. In fact, the attitude of Spain towards England at that time was the greatest obstacle which militated against the success of his colonies. His ships and his valor were necessary to suppress and check the insolence and ambition of Spain, who designed to conquer England and become mistress of the world. By his valor, loyalty, and wisdom Raleigh was largely instrumental in bringing about the failure of those plans and in defeating the Spanish fleet, which had been boastfully named The Invincible Armada. Again his zeal and cool daring won for England the great victory of Cadiz, which has always ranked as the most remarkable achievement in the annals of naval warfare. With only seven ships he dashed in and destroyed a large Spanish

fleet (fifty-five ships) in its own harbor with a dexterity and valor not surpassed even by Dewey at Manila nor by Schley at Santiago.

Spain was always his foe because she feared him, and it seems like the Nemesis of fate that three hundred years later the death-blow of Spain as a world power was dealt in Manila Bay by the nation which Raleigh strove so hard to plant, himself all unconscious of what the years were to bring. On that famous morning when Dewey startled the world and chastised Spain for her insolence and cruelty, the ship which fired the first shot in a battle destined to change the rating of two nations, the ship which first replied to the fire of the Spanish forts, as if answering the challenge of an old-time foe,—that ship was the *Raleigh*, named in honor of that great man by the nation he had fostered, and in that battle Raleigh's foe was humbled, Raleigh's fame perpetuated, and Raleigh's death avenged.

After the death of Elizabeth the star of Raleigh set. He whose most valiant work had been the defense of England against the attacks of Spain was falsely charged with treasonable negotiations with Spain, and after a farce of a trial was thrown into prison, where he remained more than twelve years. The only mitigations of the horrors of prison life were the presence of his devoted wife and his books. He had always been a student, and he spent the weary hours of his long confinement in that companionship which is known only to those who really love books, and to such minds they prove a panacea for sorrow and injustice. During that imprisonment he wrote his famous "History of the World," marking the eventful epoch by writing a history of the Old World at the same time that he was opening the gates of the future by planting English colonies in the New World. As soon as he was released from prison his mind returned to schemes of exploration. He made a voyage to South America, where new disasters befell him, and where his oldest son was killed. Shattered by grief and misfortune he returned to England, where his enemies had planned his certain downfall. Again he was sent to prison, but not for a long time, for soon his princely head paid the penalty which true greatness has too often paid to the power of a weak king. As a subject he was loyal and valiant, as a husband faithful and devoted, as a father affectionate and inspiring, as a scholar distinguished in prose and poetry, as a soldier he won fame and fortune, as a statesman he contributed to the renown of his sovereign's realm, and as a man he lived and died guided by the highest ideals. This was the man who

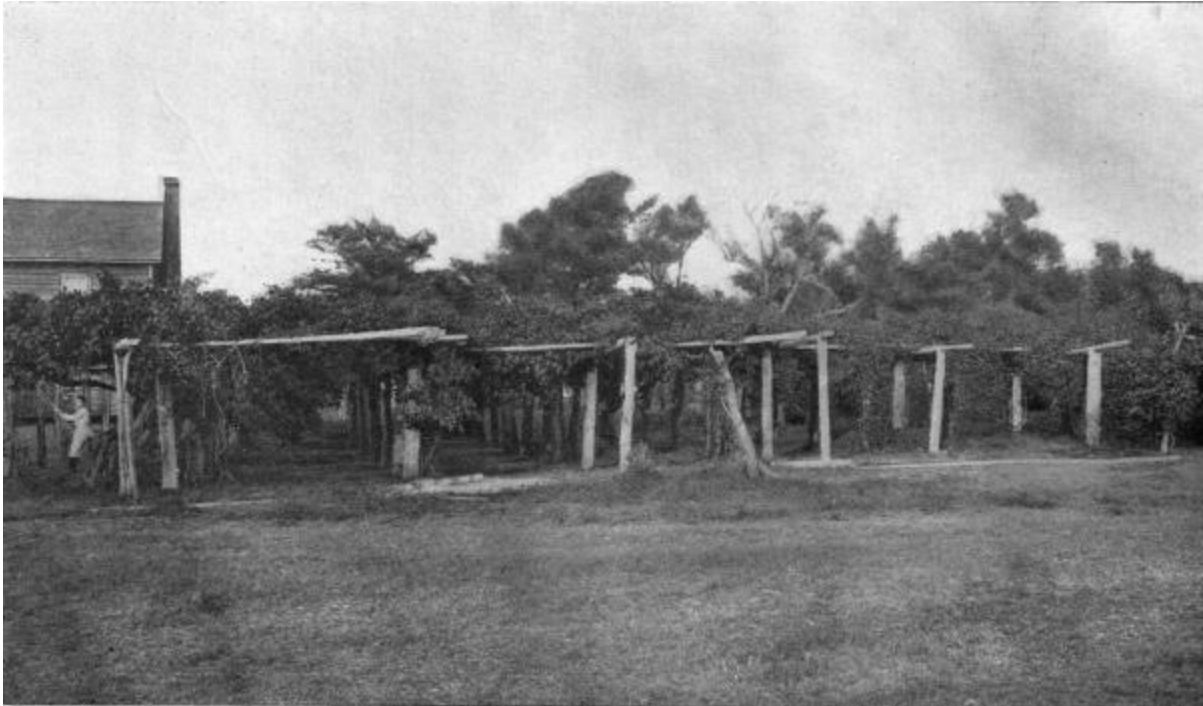
spent a fortune trying to establish English colonies in North America, and who sent repeated expeditions to the island of Roanoak, situated where the waters of the Albemarle and Pamlico Sounds meet, on the coast of North Carolina, but which was then called Virginia.

The island wears a cluster of historic jewels which should endear it to all patriotic Anglo-Americans. To them it should be the most sacred, the best loved spot in all the United States. There the first English settlements were made which led to English supremacy in the New World. There the first home altar was reared and the first child of English parents in the United States was born and baptized. There the blood of Englishmen first dyed the sod of North America, and there the first attempts at English agriculture were made. There was enacted the tragedy of American colonization, the disappearance of Raleigh's Lost Colony, and there the sacrament of baptism was first administered in the United States. Roanoak Island is a beautiful place, with fertile soil and wild luxuriance of vine-covered forests which are enveloped in a deep solitude which has become dignity. Restless waters ebb and flow by its side, restless winds kiss its bare sand dunes, a genial sun brings to maturity its wealth of tree and vine and shrub. Protected from the storms which ravage the ocean beyond, it sleeps in quiet beauty, content with its heritage of fame as *the first home of the English race in America*.

Its isolated position, its wild beauty, its tragic associations, its dignified repose, all seem to have set it aside from the rush of modern progress that it might become a shrine for the homage of a patriotic people.

The wonderful fertility of the soil of this island seemed a marvel to the early explorers, all of whom have testified to it. Ralph Lane, governor of the colony of 1585, in writing to Raleigh of the island and the surrounding country, declared it to be "the goodliest soil under the cope of heaven," and that "being inhabited with English no realm in Christendom were comparable to it;" every word of which is true now, provided that the English who inhabit it follow the suggestions of nature and adopt horticulture as the developing means. The surrounding country as well as Roanoak Island has a wealth of climbing vines and clustering grapes which point instinctively to grape culture. Amadas and Barlowe (1584) wrote that they found the land "so full of grapes as the very beating and surge of the sea overflowed them, of which we found such plenty, as well there as in all

places else, both on the sand and on the green soil, on the hills as on the plains, as well as on every little shrub as also climbing towards the top of high cedars, that I think in all the world the like abundance is not to be found."



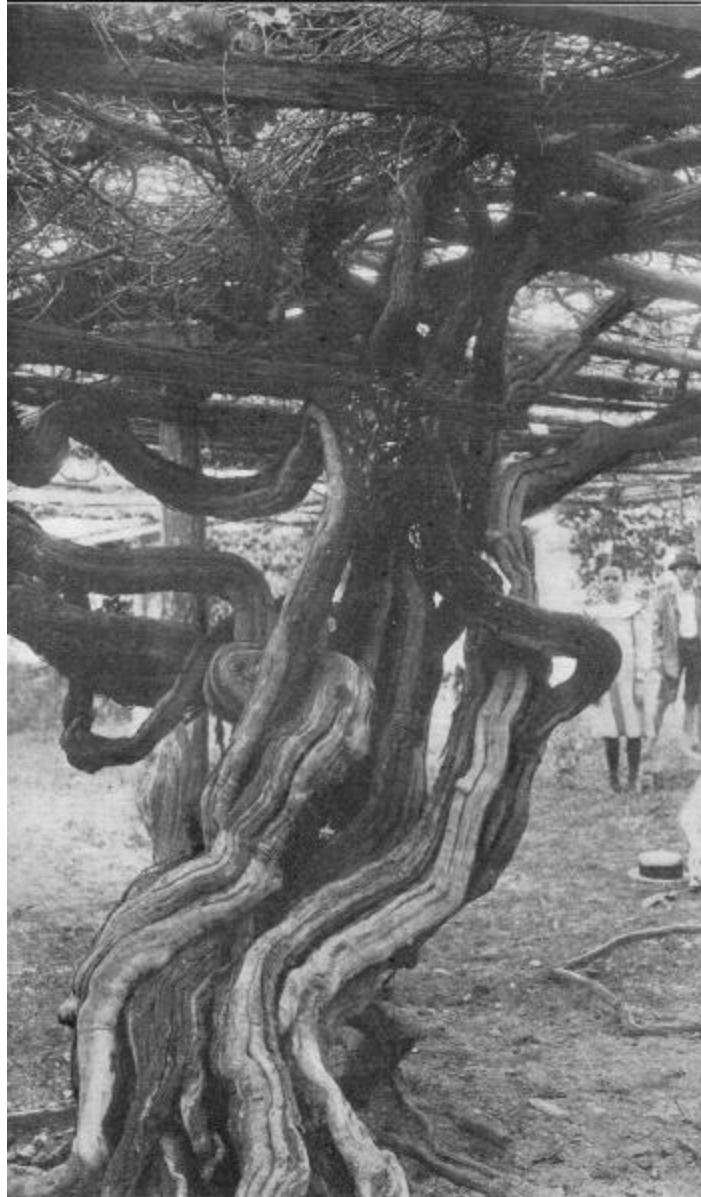
A Scuppernong Vineyard, Roanoke Island

Surely no other such natural vineyard was ever found outside the fabled Garden of the Gods!

Even in this generation an old resident of the Banks, an ante-bellum pilot on these waters, has testified that his grandfather could remember the time "when if a vessel were stranded on any of the beaches the crew could crawl to land on the grapevines hanging over where now there is only a dry sand beach." Throughout the eastern part of that State (North Carolina) the grape riots in natural luxuriance and is luscious and fragrant. Many varieties remain wild, while others have been improved by cultivation. The three finest native American grapes, the Catawba, the Isabella, and the Scuppernong, are all indigenous to the soil of North Carolina. The Catawba, native to the banks of the river Catawba, from which it takes its name, is still found wild in North Carolina, while it has become celebrated at the North as a table-grape, and in Ohio as a wine-grape. In its adopted home it has revolutionized land values because of the money value of the product.

The Isabella grape, so generally cultivated for table use, is thought to be a hybrid between the Burgundy and the native fox-grape of the Carolinas. The tradition runs that the Burgundy was brought to South Carolina by the Huguenots, and that cuttings from this hybrid were brought to North Carolina and successfully propagated. Mrs. Isabella Gibbs, for whom this well-known grape was named, carried a vine from North Carolina to Long Island, where it attracted attention because of its hardiness.

To the people of the South Atlantic coast the Scuppernong is by far the most important of the native grapes, for while it refuses to flourish away from its native home, yet its great possibilities as a wine-grape are beginning to be appreciated. All the early explorers gave it special mention. Hariot in his famous Narrative wrote, "There are two kinds of grapes that the soil does yield naturally, the one is small and sour, of the ordinary bigness of ours in England; the other far greater and of *himself luscious sweet*. When they are planted and husbanded as they ought, a principal commodity of wines by them may be raised." (Hakluyt, 1586.) Lawson in his history (1714) describes several varieties, and dwells on the abundant supply of grapes and the great tangles of green vines. He wrote of a native *white* grape, which many in that day thought existed only in his imagination; but it was a reality and was the now well-known Scuppernong, whose fame history and tradition both perpetuate, and whose real worth, greater than its legendary fame, is now being recognized and appreciated. There are several varieties of the Scuppernong, all luscious and yielding rich juices, and when ripe they fill the air with a fragrance unknown to any other grape.



Old "Mother" Scuppernong Vine.

The first Scuppernong vine known to history was found on the mainland of the North Carolina coast by Amadas and Barlowe on their first voyage (1584). Tradition relates that they transplanted this vine to Roanoke Island. On this island there still flourishes an old vine, which despite its gnarled body and evident age continues to bear fruit. It is claimed that it is the same vine Amadas and Barlowe planted. Some insist that it was planted by Sir Walter Raleigh himself, but as that famous knight did not realize his wish to visit his new possessions in North America, the honor of having planted the

vine must revert to Amadas and Barlowe. It seems to be endowed with perennial youth, and the harvest from its branches is an annual certainty.

What the early explorers testified as to the abundant supply of grapes on the Carolina coast, and the propitious conditions existing for the propagation of the vine, is equally true to-day. The manifest destiny of North Carolina as the rival of Southern France in the production of wines seems to be inevitable. The marvel is how it has been so long delayed after Hariot's special mention of such possibilities. Hariot was a close observer with a practical mind, and the presence of an indigenous supply of material to sustain an important industry suggested to him that the people coming to this grape-laden land might establish such an industry to their advantage. The delay of the development of grape-culture in its native home can only be explained on the theory that when nature boldly invites, man becomes shy. This indifference to grape-culture is peculiar to America, for in Europe all the aristocracy who are land-owners, where the climate makes it possible, are cultivators of the grape, take great pride in their wines, boast of their rare and fine vintages, and hold the making of wine as one of the fine arts.

The original Scuppernong has white skin, white pulp, white juice, and makes a white wine. Other varieties have dark purple skins and yield a reddish juice which makes a red wine. The dark varieties are said to be *seedlings* from the original white variety, and tradition explains the metamorphosis in this way.



Among the Scuppernongs.—A Modern Vineyard.

In the magic spring made famous in the legend of The White Doe, after the blood of Virginia Dare had melted from the silver arrow into the water of the spring, then the water disappeared. As the legend says:

"Dry became the magic fountain,
Leaving bare the silver arrow."

Then while O-kis-ko looked on in wonderment he saw

"a tiny shoot with leaflets
Pushing upward to the sunlight."

Tradition says that this "tiny shoot with leaflets" was a young seedling of the Scuppernong which had sprouted in the edge of the water, and it was not seen by O-kis-ko until all the water had disappeared. Then he saw it and immediately associated its appearance with the magic arrow, and so left it "reaching upward to the sunlight." After many days he returned to the spot-drawn by an irresistible longing, and covered the fatal arrow, which had brought him so much woe, with earth and leaves to hide it from his sight. The earth and leaves furnished the necessary nourishment to the tiny vine,

which reached out with strength and vigor, and finding friendly bushes upon which to climb, it soon made a sheltering bower above the spot where had bubbled the magic spring. This tiny green bower became the favorite retreat of O-kis-ko, where he would linger to cherish thoughts of his lost love, Virginia Dare, and marvel on the wonders of her death. Then it came to pass that when fruit came upon this vine, lo! it was purple in hue instead of white like the other grapes, and yielded a *red* juice. Full of superstition, and still credulous of marvels, O-kis-ko imagined the change to be due to the magic arrow buried at its root. He gathered the grapes and pressed the juice from them, and lo! it was *red*—it was the semblance of blood, *Virginia Dare's blood*, absorbed from the water (in which it had melted from the arrow) by the vine, and yet potent for good. Surely it held some unseen power, for it combined in some mystic way through the mysterious earth at his feet all the power of the magic spring, the power of the silver arrow, and the power of human blood consecrated through human love. He reverently drank the juice of this new vine, believing that it would in some way link him with the spirit of her he had loved and lost. Year after year he drank this juice and fed his soul on thoughts of love, making unconsciously a sacrament, and finding happiness in the thought that the blood of the maiden would feed his spirit and lead him to her at last. To become good like her and to go to her became his highest hope. Aspiration had been born in his soul, and quickened by love it could not die, but led him blindly to strive to reach her, and such striving is never in vain.



A "Virginia Dare" Vineyard.

Another fact that should be enshrined in the hearts and perpetuated in the memorials of the nation, is that on Roanoke Island the first Christian baptism in the United States was administered. By order of Sir Walter Raleigh, Manteo, the friendly Indian chief, was baptized soon after the arrival of the colony under Governor White, and the following Sunday Virginia Dare, the granddaughter of Governor White, was baptized, both events being officially reported to Raleigh. In this day of religious freedom any enforced adoption of religious forms shocks our pious instincts. Yet baptism has always been considered *necessary* to salvation, and in the past the zeal of Christians for the salvation of their fellow-men often assumed the form of mild force. We read where the Spaniards, always religious fanatics, administered the Holy Sacrament to thousands in Central America and Mexico *at the point of the sword*; their zeal misleading them to force upon those less enlightened than themselves the hope of that heaven which they believed to be accessible only through certain Christian rites. So to order the baptism of an Indian chief seems a simple, kindly thing, and most probably Manteo desired it done. The only other Indian who received baptism in those early settlements was Pocahontas, in 1614. She was a captive at the time and held as a hostage to induce Powhatan to comply with certain demands of the colonists at Jamestown.

Despite the fact that Virginia Dare was baptized twenty-seven years earlier than Pocahontas, yet it is the Indian Princess who is figured in the painting on the walls of the dome of the Capitol at Washington as receiving the first baptism in the colonies. Buried in the annals of that time lies the fact that twenty-seven years before any colonist even came to Jamestown, Virginia Dare was born and baptized, as the sequence of Christian birth and as the child of Christian parents. Virginia Dare was not a myth. She was a living, breathing reality, a human creature of good English descent, the granddaughter of the governor of the colonies, the daughter of the assistant governor, and a sharer in the mysterious fate of Raleigh's Lost Colony. The historical facts of her life and the legend of her fate and death are contained in the pages of "The White Doe."

Her baptism would not have been mentioned in the records if it had not been official and proper. In a new land, surrounded by dangers and difficulties, with strange environment to divert the mind to other channels, it would have been easy and natural for her baptism to have been delayed if not altogether neglected amid the stress of events. Her prompt baptism and the official report of the event to Sir Walter Raleigh is convincing testimony to the presence of a chaplain at Roanoke.

THE FIRST BAPTISM IN THE WILDS OF AMERICA!

How naturally the scene rises before us. The young mother, her heart thrilling with the mysteries of love and life, and elated with the joy of motherhood, alert to the dangers of the new land, and suspicious of the strange people among whom her blue-eyed treasure must live, yet yielding cheerfully to the busy smiling English women who had crossed the ocean with her, and now with womanly intuition ministered to her needs. We can picture them making tidy the confused household, and stilling the cries of the infant as they prepare her to receive the sign of the cross. We can almost picture them deliberating over a choice from among their limited supply of vessels of one worthy to become the receptacle of the water to be used. It was on the Sabbath-Day, and the dedication to God of the wee creature who had so newly come among them was a fitting observance of the day. The solemn words of the ritual of the English Church, never before spoken in that primeval forest, must have awakened mysterious vibrations which

linger yet and give to Roanoak Island that atmosphere of perpetual repose which envelops it. There must have come to those who witnessed the scene that holy Sabbath-Day, just as it comes now to those who view it from afar, a deep realization that the God of the English and the Great Spirit of the Indian are one and the same, then, now, and evermore. The One God to whom in baptism Virginia Dare was brought and in whose name Manteo the savage was signed with the cross and given the promise of salvation, and who remains the God of the millions of English-speaking people who now worship in the land which was then and there dedicated to the service of Christ.

The mist of oblivion fades before the light of Truth, and Virginia Dare will be a shining jewel in the Chaplet of Memories which some day Christian America will place upon the tomb of the Past.

PREFACE

A familiar knowledge of the history of one's own country increases patriotism and stimulates valor. For this reason the study of written records called history should be supplemented by research into myths, folk-lore, and legends. While the value of history lies ever in its truth, it must yet bear the ideals of the people who participated in the events narrated. Tradition was the mother of all history, and was necessarily robed in the superstitions of the era of which the tradition tells. History writers, jealously guarding the truth, have striven to banish all traditions which seemed colored by fancy or even freighted with a moral lesson. These exiled traditions, bearing the seed-germs of truth, cannot die, but, like wandering spirits, float down the centuries enveloped in the mists of superstition, until finally, embodied in romance or song, they assume a permanent form called legend and become the heritage of a people. Legends are the satellites of history because they have their origin in the same events, and the history of all countries is interspersed with them.

The legend of The White Doe is probably the oldest and possibly the least known of all the legends which relate to the history of the United States. It is a genuine American legend, and the facts from which it had its origin form the first chapter in the history of English colonization in North America. Those facts are found in the repeated attempts of Sir Walter Raleigh to establish an English colony in the New World. The Spaniards were in Florida, the French were in Nova Scotia, but England had gained no possessions in North America when Raleigh began his efforts. This fact assumes more importance when we remember that civilization has made the greatest progress in those parts of America where the English became dominant. In South America, dominated by the Spaniards, civilization has made no strides, while in the United States a new nation has arisen whose ultimate destiny none may limit or foretell. As the gates of a new century open and disclose almost unlimited fields for human progress, this new nation, with an enthusiasm and courage born of success, has taken her place to lead in the eternal forward search for better opportunities and higher life for the human race. All this grand destiny, all this ripening opportunity, like

a harvest from a few seeds, is traced back, event after event, to the early struggles of those who braved the dangers of sea and forest in the attempts to colonize America. Those pioneer efforts, so generously promoted by Sir Walter Raleigh, though only partially successful, were the stepping-stones which later led to the better-known settlement of Jamestown, in Virginia. A brief *résumé* of those stepping-stones will make them familiar to all.

In 1584 Queen Elizabeth made a grant to Raleigh for all the land from Nova Scotia to Florida, which was called Virginia, in honor of the Virgin Queen, as Elizabeth was called.

The first expedition sent out under this grant was in the same year, 1584, and was entirely at the expense of Sir Walter Raleigh, as were all of the expeditions up to 1590. It was solely for the purpose of exploration, and was under the command of Amadas and Barlowe, who, after coasting along the Atlantic shores, entered Pamlico Sound and landed on the island of Roanoke, on the coast of the present State of North Carolina. They made the acquaintance of the tribes there resident, explored the country on the coast, and returned to England to bear enthusiastic testimony to the delightsomeness of the country. They took with them back to England two native Indian chiefs, Manteo and Wanchese, who returned to America on a subsequent voyage, as the official records tell.

The following year, 1585, a colony of one hundred and seven men landed on this same island of Roanoke. They came organized to occupy and possess the land granted to Raleigh, and to secure such benefits therefrom as in those days were deemed valuable. They remained one year, exploring the country and trying to establish relations with the Indians. They built houses, planted crops, and looked forward to the arrival of more men and food, which had been promised from England. But no ships came, provisions grew scarce, and before the crops they had planted were mature enough to harvest, Sir Francis Drake, the great sea-rover of that day, appeared off the island with a fleet of vessels.

Knowing the dangers of that coast, he did not attempt to come to the island, but sent in to learn of the welfare of the colony, and offered to supply their immediate needs. They asked, among other things, that their sick and weak men be taken back to England, that food for those who remained be given

them, and for a vessel in which they might return home if they so desired, all of which Drake granted. But a dreadful storm arose, which lasted three days and drove the promised vessel out to sea, with a goodly number of the colonists and the promised food on board. Seeing thus a part of their number and their food gone, the remaining colonists became homesick and panic-stricken and begged Drake to take them *all* to England, which he did. Thus ended the first attempt at English colonization in North America.

Fifteen days after their departure Sir Richard Grenville arrived with three vessels, bringing the promised supplies, but found the men gone. Wishing to hold the country for England until another colony could arrive, he left fifteen men on the island with provisions for two years, and he returned to England. Those fifteen men are supposed to have been murdered and captured by the Indians, as the next colony found only some bones, a ruined fort, and empty houses in which deer were feeding.

The leaving of those fifteen men is considered the second attempt at colonization, and is recognized as a failure. But all success is built only by persistent repetition of effort, and so, in 1587, another colony came from England to this same island of Roanoak. Among those colonists were seventeen women and nine children, thus proving the intention of making permanent homes, and the hope of establishing family ties which should for all time unite England and North America. A few days after the arrival of this colony at Roanoak, Virginia Dare was born,—she being the first child born of English parents on the soil of North America,—and because she was the first child born in Virginia she was called Virginia. Her mother, Eleanor Dare, was the daughter of John White, the governor of the colony, and the wife of one of the assistant governors.

The Sunday following her birth she was baptized, this being another fact of official record.

By Sir Walter Raleigh's command the rite of baptism had been administered, a few days earlier, to Manteo, an Indian chief, who had visited England with a returning expedition, as previously mentioned. This baptism of the adult Indian and of the white infant were the first Christian sacraments administered in North America, and are worthy of commemoration.

The colonists soon found that to make possible and permanent their home in a new land many things were needed more than they had provided. So at their urgent request their leader, Governor White, grandfather of Virginia Dare, consented to return to England to secure the needed supplies, with which he was to return to them the following year. When White reached England he found war going on with Spain, and England threatened with an invasion by the famous Spanish Armada. His queen needed and demanded his services, and not until 1590—three years later—did he succeed in returning to America. When at last he came the colonists had disappeared, and the only clue to their fate was the word "Croatoan," which he found carved on a tree; it having been agreed between them that if they changed their place of abode in his absence they would carve on a tree the name of the place to which they had gone.

The arrival of those colonists, the birth and baptism of Virginia Dare, the return of White to England, the disappearance of the colony, and the finding of the word Croatoan, these facts form the record of that colony, the disappearance of which is a mystery which history has not solved.

But tradition illumines many periods of the past which history leaves in darkness, and tradition tells how this colony found among friendly Indians a refuge from the dangers of Roanoak Island, and how this infant grew into fair maidenhood, and was changed by the sorcery of a rejected lover into a *white doe*, which roamed the lonely island and bore a charmed life, and how finally true love triumphed over magic and restored her to human form,—only to result in the death of the maiden from a silver arrow shot by a cruel chieftain.

This tradition of a white doe and a silver arrow has survived through three centuries, and not only lingers where the events occurred, but some portions of it are found wherever in our land forests abound and deer abide. From Maine to Florida lumbermen are everywhere familiar with an old superstition that to see a white doe is an evil omen. In some localities lumbermen will quit work if a white deer is seen. That such a creature as a white deer really exists is demonstrated by their capture and exhibition in menageries, and to-day the rude hunters of the Alleghany Mountains believe that only a silver arrow will kill a white deer.

The disappearance of this colony has been truly called "the tragedy of American colonization," and around it has hung a pathetic interest which ever leads to renewed investigation, in the hope of solving the mystery. From recent search into the subject by students of history a chain of evidence has been woven from which it has come to be believed that the lost colony, hopeless of succor from England, and deprived of all other human associations, became a part of a tribe of friendly Croatoan Indians, shared their wanderings, and intermarried with them, and that their descendants are to be found to-day among the Croatoan Indians of Robeson County, North Carolina.

(Those who desire to investigate this supposed solution of the mystery can easily secure the facts and the conclusions formed by those who have made a careful study of the subject.)

Of course, it can never be known *certainly* whether Virginia Dare was or was not of that number, but the full tradition of her life among the Indians is embodied in the legend of The White Doe.

Much has been written about the Indian princess Pocahontas, and much sentiment has clustered around her association with the Jamestown colony, while few have given thought to the young English girl whose birth, baptism, and mysterious disappearance link her forever with the earlier tragedies of the same era of history. It seems a strange coincidence that the Indian maiden Pocahontas, friend and companion of the *White Man*, having adopted *his* people as her own, should sleep in death on English soil, while the English maiden, Virginia Dare, friend and companion of the *Red Man*, having adopted his people as *her* own, should sleep in death on American soil,—the two maidens thus exchanging nationality, and linking in life and in death the two countries whose destinies seem most naturally to intermingle.

The scattered fragments of this legend have been carefully collected and woven into symmetry for preservation. Notes from authentic sources have been appended for the benefit of searchers into the historical basis of the poem, which is offered to the public with the hope that it may increase interest in the early history of our home land and strengthen the tie which binds England and the United States.

SALLIE SOUTHALL COTTEN.



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Frontispiece from an original drawing
by May Louise Barrett.

Maps and remaining illustrations
reproduced from Theodore de Bry's
edition of "The True Pictures and
Fashions of the People in that Parte of
America now called Virginia," 1590.

PROLOGUE

In the tomb of vanished ages sleep th'
 ungarnered truths of Time,
Where the pall of silence covers deeds of
 honor and of crime;
Deeds of sacrifice and danger, which the
 careless earth forgets,
There, in ever-deep'ning shadows, lie
 embalmed in mute regrets.
Would-be-gleaners of the Present vainly
 grobe amid this gloom;
Flowers of Truth to be immortal must be
 gathered while they bloom,
Else they pass into the Silence, man's
 neglect their only blight,
And the Gleaner of the Ages stores them
 far from human sight.
Yet a perfume, sweet and subtle, lingers
 where each flower grew,
Rising from the shattered petals, bathed and
 freshened by the dew;
And this perfume, in the twilight, forms a
 mist beneath the skies,
Out of which, like airy phantoms, legends
 and traditions rise;
For the Seeds of Truth are buried in a
 legend's inmost heart,
To transplant them in the sunlight justifies
 the poet's art.



The arrival of the Englishmen in Virginia

THE SEEDS OF TRUTH

ROANOAK, 1587

Shimmering waters, aweary of
tossing,
Hopeful of rest, ripple on to the
shore;
Dimpling with light, as they waver
and quiver,
Echoing faintly the ocean's wild
roar.
Locked in the arms of the tremulous
waters
Nestles an island, with beauty
abloom,
Where the warm kiss of an amorous
summer
Fills all the air with a languid
perfume.
Windward, the roar of the turbulent
breakers
Warns of the dangers of rock and of
reef;
Burdened with mem'ries of
sorrowful shipwreck,
They break on the sands in torrents
of grief.
Leeward, the forest, grown giant in
greenness,
Shelters a land where a fervid sun
shines;

Wild with the beauty of riotous
nature,
Thick with the tangles of fruit-laden
vines.^[A]
From fragrant clusters, grown
purple with ripeness,
Rare, spicy odors float out to the
sea,^[B]
Where the gray gulls flit with
restless endeavor,
Skimming the waves in their
frolicsome glee.

Out from the shore stalks the stately
white heron,
Seeking his food from the deep
without fear,
Gracefully waving wide wings as he
rises
When the canoe of the Indian draws
near.
Through reedy brake and the
tangled sea-grasses
Wander the stag and the timid-eyed
doe^[C]
Down to the water's edge, watchful
and wary
For arrows that fly from the red
hunter's bow.
Fearless Red Hunter! his birthright
the forest,
Lithe as the antelope, joyous and
free.
Trusting his bow for his food and
his freedom,
Wresting a tribute from forest and
sea,

No chilling forecast of doom in the
future
Daunts his brave spirit, by freedom
made bold.
Far o'er the wildwood he roams at
his pleasure,
The fierce, brawny Red Man is king
of the wold.



"The fierce, brawny Red Man is king of the wold"

Lo! in the offing the white sails are
gleaming,
Ships from afar to the land drawing
nigh;
Laden with men, strong and brave
to meet danger,

Stalwart of form, fair of skin, blue
of eye.
Boldly they land where the white
man is alien;
Women are with them, with hearts
true and brave;
Sadly they stand where their
countrymen perished, ^[D]
Seeking a home where *they* found
but a grave.

Friendly red hunters greet them with
kindness,
Tell the sad tale how their
countrymen died, ^[E]
Beg for a token of friendship and
safety, ^[F]
Promise in love and in peace to
abide.
Manteo's heart glows with friendly
remembrance,
He greets them as brothers and
offers good cheer;
No thrill of welcome is felt by
Wanchese, ^[G]
His heart is bitter with malice and
fear.
Envyng men his superiors in
wisdom,
Fearing a race his superiors in skill;
Sullen and silent he watches the
strangers,
Whom from the first he determines
to kill.

Then the sign of the Cross, on the
brow of the Indian, ^[H]

Seals to the savage the promise of
life;
Sweet symbol of sacrifice, emblem
of duty,
Standard of Peace, though borne
amidst strife:
Draped with the sombre, stained
banner of Conquest,
Dark with the guilt of man's murder
and greed,
Yet bright with God's message of
love and forgiveness
Unto a universe welded to creed.

Gently the morning breeze tosses
the tree-tops,
Low ebbs the tide on the outlying
sand;
When a tiny white babe opens eyes
to the sunlight,^[1]
Heaven's sweet pledge for the weal
of the land.
Babe of the Wilderness! tenderly
cherished!
Signed with the Cross on the next
Sabbath Day;
Brave English Mother! through
danger and sorrow,
For a nation of Christians thou
ledest the way.

Back to the home-land, across the
deep water,
Goes the wise leader, their needs to
abate;^[2]
Leaving with sorrow the babe and
its mother

In a strange land as a hostage to
Fate.
Many long months pass in busy
home-making,
Sweet English customs prevail on
the isle;
Anxious eyes watch for the ship in
the offing,
Saddened hearts droop, but the lips
bravely smile.

Gone are the sweet dreamy days of
the summer,
In from the ocean the winter winds
shriek;
Dangers encompass and enemies
threaten,
Mother and child other refuge must
seek.
Mother and child, as in Bethlehem
story,
Flee from the hate of their blood-
thirsty foes;
Hopeless of help from their own
land and people,
They seek friendly tribes to find rest
from their woes.

To the fair borders of Croatoan
Island,
Over the night-covered waters they
flee;
Seeking for safety with Manteo's
people,
Leaving the word "Croatoan" on a
tree. [\[K\]](#)

Name of the refuge in which they
sought shelter,
Only the name of a tribe, nothing
more;^[L]
Sign whereby those who would seek
them might follow
To their new home on the
Croatoan's shore.

Why did they leave the rude fort
they had builded?
Why did they seek far away a new
home?
O innocent babe! Roanoak's lost
nestling!
How shall we learn where thy
footsteps did roam?
'Mid the rude tribes of the primeval
forest,
Bearing the signet of Christ on thy
brow,
Wert thou the teacher and guide of
the savage?
Who, of thy mission, can aught tell
us now?
Through the dim ages comes only
the perfume,
Left where the flowers of Truth fell
to earth;
With ne'er a gleaner to treasure the
blossoms,
Save the sweet petals of baptism
and birth.
Vainly we seek on Time's shore for
thy footprints,
Hid in a mist of pathos is thy fate;

Yet of a life under savage
enchantment
Quaint Indian legends do strangely
relate.

FOOTNOTES:

- [A] See Appendix, Note [a](#).
 - [B] See Appendix, Note [b](#).
 - [C] See Appendix, Note [c](#).
 - [D] See Appendix, Note [d](#).
 - [E] See Appendix, Note [e](#).
 - [F] See Appendix, Note [e](#).
 - [G] Pronounced Wan-chess-e.
 - [H] See Appendix, Note [f](#).
 - [I] See Appendix, Note [g](#).
 - [J] See Appendix, Note [h](#).
 - [K] See Appendix, Note [k](#).
 - [L] See Appendix, Note [k](#).
-

THE LEGEND OF THE WHITE DOE

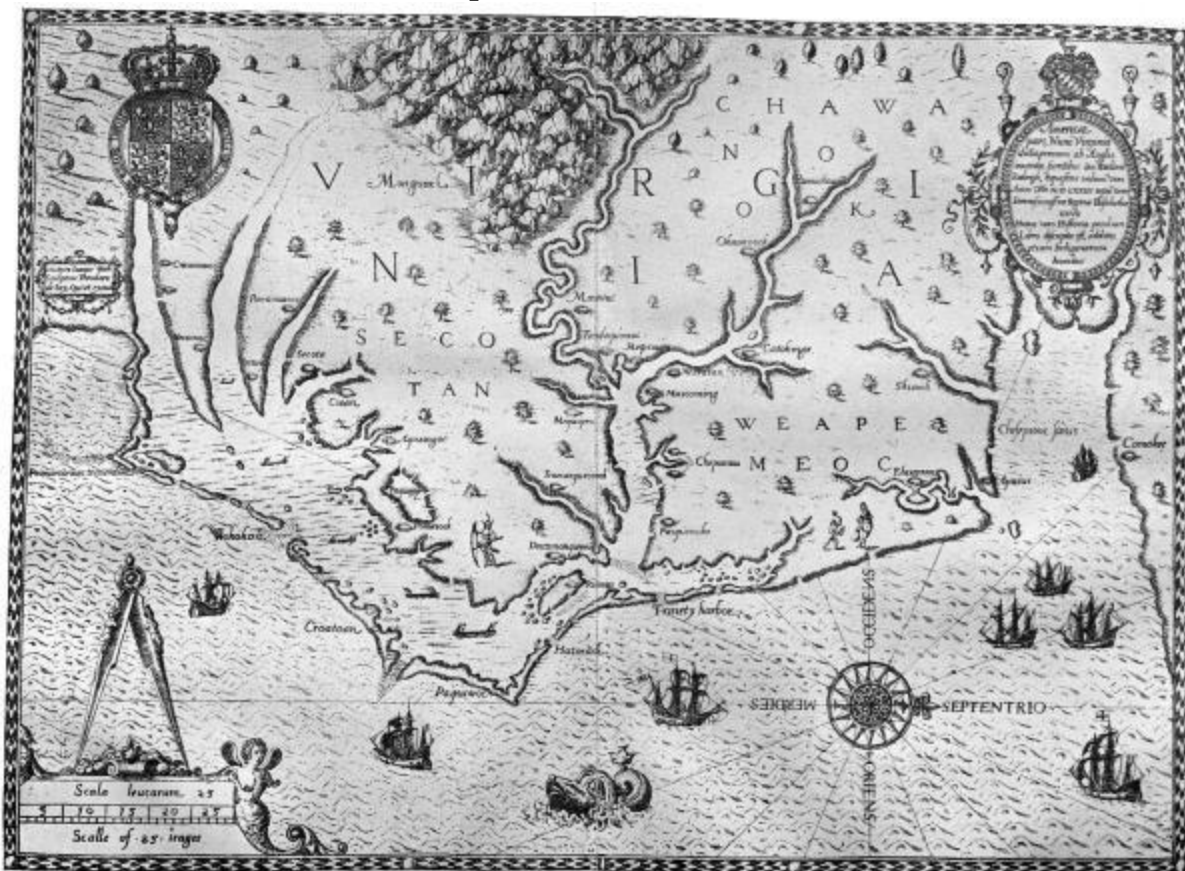


I

THE REFUGEES

In the Land-of-Wind-and-Water,
Loud the sea bemoaned its
 sameness;
Dashing shoreward with impatience
To explore the landward mysteries.
On the sand the waves spread
 boldly,
Vainly striving to reach higher;
Then abashed by vain ambition,
Glided to their ordained duty.
There the pine-tree, tall and stately,
Whispered low the ocean's murmur;
Strove to soothe the restless waters
With its lullaby of sighing.
There the tall and dank sea-grasses,
From the storm-tide gathered
 secrets
Of the caverns filled with treasures,
Milky pearls and tinted coral,
Stores of amber and of jacinth,
In the caves festooned with sea-
 weed,
Where the Sea-King held his revels
And the Naiads danced in beauty.
In this Land-of-Wind-and-Water,
Dowered with the sunshine's
 splendor,
Juicy grapes grew in profusion,
Draping all the trees with greenness,

And the maize grew hard and
 yellow,
 With the sunshine in its kernels.
 Through the forest roamed the black
 bear,
 And the red deer boldly herded;
 Through the air flew birds of flavor,
 And the sea was full of fishes,
 Till the Red Man knew no hunger,
 And his wigwam hung with
 trophies.



The Land-of-Wind-and-Water

There brave Man-te-o, the Faithful,
 Ruled the Cro-a-to-ans with
 firmness,
 Dwelt in peace beside the waters,

Smoked his pipe beneath the pine-
tree,
Gazed with pride upon his bear-
skins
Which hung ready for the winter.
Told his people all the marvels
Of the Land-of-the-Pale-Faces;
Of the ships with wings like sea-
birds
Wherein he had crossed the water;
[\[M\]](#)

Of the Pale-Face Weroanza^{[\[N\]](#)}
Whom he saw in her own country;
Of her robes of silken texture,
Of her wisdom and her power;
Told them of her warlike people
And their ships which breathed the
lightning.
How he pledged with them a
friendship,
Hoping they would come to teach
him
How to make his people mighty,
How to make them strong in battle
So the other tribes would fear them.
And the dream of future greatness
Filled the Cro-a-to-ans with
courage;
And their hearts grew warm and
friendly
To the race of white-faced strangers.

When bold white men came among
them,
To the isle of Ro-a-no-ak,
Man-te-o, the friendly Weroance,
Faithful proved to all his pledges.

Smoked with them the pipe of
friendship,
Took their God to be his Father;
Took upon his swarthy forehead
Their strange emblem of salvation,
[O]

Emblem of the One Great Spirit,
Father of all tribes and nations.
Man-te-o, the friend and brother,
Bade them fear the false Wan-ches-
e,
And the Weroance Win-gin-a,
Whose hearts burned with bitter
hatred
For the men they feared in combat,
For the strangers who defied them.



Man-te-o, a chiefe lorde of Roanoak

When the Pale-Face, weak and
hungry,
Feeble from continued labor,
Shivered in the blasts of winter
Which blew cold across the water,
Then Wan-ches-e planned their ruin,
With Win-gin-a sought to slay them.

To the isle of Ro-a-no-ak,

Where the Pale-Face slept
unguarded,
Sped the swift canoes of Red Men,
Gliding through the silent shadows.
As the sky grew red with dawning,
[P]

While they dreamed of home and
kindred,
Suddenly with whoop of murder
Wily Indians swarmed around them.

Skill of Pale-Face, craft of Red
Man,
Met in fierce, determined battle;
While within the Fort called Raleigh
Many arrows fell, like raindrops.
Arrows tipped with serpent's poison,
Arrows tipped with blazing rosin,
Winged with savage thirst for
murder,
Aimed with cruel skill to torture.
Threatened by the blazing roof-tree
Then the Pale-Face crouched in
terror;
Saw the folly of resistance,
Feared his doom, and fled for safety.

Man-te-o, alert for danger,
From afar saw signs of conflict;
Saw the waves of smoke ascending
Heavenward, like prayers for
rescue.
Swift, with boats and trusty
warriors,
Crossed he then to Ro-a-no-ak;
Strong to help his Pale-Face
brothers,

Faithful to his friendly pledges.

As the daylight slowly faded,
Hopeless of the bloody struggle,
Stealthily the Pale-Face warriors
Fled with Man-te-o's brave people.
Left they then the Fort called
 Raleigh,
Left the dead within its stockade;
Sought another island refuge,
Hoping there to rest in safety.

Man-te-o sought for the mother, ^[Q]
She with babe there born and
 nurtured
'Neath the shadow of disaster,
In the Land-of-Wind-and-Water.
"Come," said he, "the darkness
 falleth,
All your people must flee
 henceward;
Wan-ches-e will show no mercy,
You must not become his captive.
Take the papoose from thy bosom,
Call the white chief whom thou
 lovest,
Haste with me upon the flood-tide
To my wigwam on Wo-ko-kon."

Noiseless, she amid the conflict
Sought her heart's mate to flee with
 her;
Useless all the strife and courage,
Useless all the rude home-making;
Shrine for worship, fort for safety,
Hope of future peace and plenty,
All were vain; yet life we cherish,

Far above all boons we hold it:
So she hastened on her mission
For the life of self and loved ones.

As they neared the island border,
Pale-Face husband, child, and
 mother,
Man-te-o in silence leading,
Every sense alive to danger,
Suddenly the Pale-Face father
Thought him of the parting caution
Given by their absent leader:
If they fled in search of safety
On a tree to leave a token,
Whereby he might surely find them,
In the land which gave them shelter,
When he came again to seek them.

[R]

By his side a sturdy live-oak
Spread its green, protecting
 branches;
Quick he strove to carve the token
Which should speak to all who
 followed.

C. R. O., in bold, plain letters^[S]
Cut he in the tree's firm body,
When a random, poisoned arrow
Pierced his heart, and he fell
 lifeless.

With a smothered cry of horror,
In an agony of sorrow,
She would fain have lingered near
 him,
But that Man-te-o urged onward.
If discovered, flight was futile,

Weakness now meant worse
disaster;
She must save her helpless baby
Though her heart be rent with
anguish.

Frantic with love's desolation,
Strong with thoughts of home and
father,
With a woman's wondrous calmness
When great peril calls for action,
Safe she placed the sleeping infant
'Cross the brawny arms of Man-te-
o,
While with knife drawn from his
girdle
Carved she on another live-oak
Plain, the one word "CROATOAN"
[\[T\]](#)

As a sign to all her people.
Trusting all to savage friendship,
Cutting hope with every letter,
Praying God to guide her father
To the haven she was seeking.

Trust is woman's strongest bulwark,
All true manhood yields unto it.
As her sad eyes turned upon him
Man-te-o was moved with pity
For the brave and tender woman,
Friendless in the land without him.

On the brow of Pale-Face baby
First he made the Holy Cross-Sign;
Then upon the sad-eyed mother
Traced the sign her people taught
him;

Then again the sacred symbol
Outlined on his own dark forehead;
And with open hand uplifted
Sealed his promise of protection;
Linking thus his pledge of safety
With her faith in Unseen Power.

Mute with grief, she trusted in him;
In his boat they crossed the water,
While the night fell like a mantle
Spread in mercy to help save them.

When in Cro-a-to-an they landed,
There they found the few survivors
Of that day of doom to many,
Glad once more to greet each other.
Man-te-o within his wigwam
From the cold wind gave them
shelter,
Shared with them his furry bear-
skins,
Made them warm, and warmth gave
courage
To meet life's relentless duties.

Then he summoned all the people,
Called the old men and the young
men,
Bade the squaws to come and listen,
Showed the papoose to the women.
They gazed on its tender whiteness,
Stroked the mother's flaxen tresses;
"'Tis a snow-papoose" they
whispered,
"It will melt when comes the
summer."

Man-te-o said to the warriors:

"Ye all know these Pale-Face people
Whom Wan-ches-e sought to
murder,
They have often made us welcome.
Brave their hearts, but few are
living,
If left friendless these will perish;
We have store of corn and venison,
They are hungry, let us feed them;
They have lightning for their
arrows,
Let them teach us how to shoot it.
They with us shall search the forest,
And our game shall be abundant;
Let them teach us their strange
wisdom
And become with us one people."

And the old men, grave in counsel,
And the young men, mute with
deference,
While the uppowoc^[U] was burning,
Pondered on his words thus spoken,
And to Man-te-o gave answer:
"All your words are full of wisdom;
We will share with them our
venison,
They shall be as our own people."

From the isle of Ro-a-no-ak
Thus the Pale-Face fled for succor,
Thus in Cro-a-to-an's fair borders
Found a home with friendly Red
Men.

Nevermore to see white faces,
Nevermore to see their home-land,
Yet to all the future ages

Sending proof of honest daring;
Forging thus a link of effort
In the chain of human progress.



FOOTNOTES:

[M] See Appendix, Note [l](#).

[N] Queen Elizabeth.

[O] See Appendix, Note [f](#).

[P] See Appendix, Note [m](#).

[Q] Eleanor Dare.

[R] See Appendix, Note [k](#).

[S] See Appendix, Note [k](#).

[T] See Appendix, Note [k](#).

[U] Tobacco.



II

THE PALE-FACE MAIDEN

Nature feels no throb of pity,
Makes no pause for human
 heartbreak;
Though with agony we quiver,
She gives forth no sign of feeling.
Waxed and waned the moon, in
 season,
Ebbbed and flowed the tides
 obedient;
Summers filled the land with plenty,
Winters chilled the summers' ardor.
No winged ships gleamed in the
 offing;
No Pale-Faces sought their kindred;
In the Land-of-Wind-and-Water
Roamed the Red Man unmolested.

While the babe of Ro-a-no-ak
Grew in strength and wondrous
 beauty;
Like a flower of the wildwood,
Bloomed beside the Indian maidens.
And Wi-no-na Skâ^[V] they called
 her,
She of all the maidens fairest.
In the tangles of her tresses
Sunbeams lingered, pale and
 yellow;
In her eyes the limpid blueness

Of the noonday sky was mirrored.
And the squaws of darksome
 features
Smiled upon her fair young beauty;
Felt their woman hearts within them
Warming to the Pale-Face maiden.
And the braves, who scorned all
 weakness,
Listened to her artless prattle,
While their savage natures softened,
Of the change themselves
 unconscious.

Like the light of summer morning
Beaming on a world in slumber
Was the face of young Wi-no-na
To the Cro-a-to-ans who loved her.
She, whose mind bore in its
 dawning
Impress of developed races,
To the rude, untutored savage
Seemed divinely 'dowed with
 reason.
She, the heir of civilization,
They, the slaves of superstition,
Gave to her a silent rev'rence,
Growing better with such giving.
Oft she told them that the Cross-
 Sign,
Made by Man-te-o before them
When he talked to his own nation,
Was the symbol of a Spirit
Great, and good, and wise, and
 loving;
He who kept the maize-fields
 fruitful,
He who filled the sea with fishes,

He who made the sun to warm them
And sent game to feed His children.

If, when in their games or councils,
They grew quarrelsome and angry,
Suddenly among them standing
Was a maiden like the sunrise,
Making with her taper finger
This strange sign which they
 respected;
And without a word of pleading
Strife and wrath would no more vex
 them,
While the influence of her presence
Lingered 'round them like
 enchantment.

Thus the babe of Ro-a-no-ak
Grew to be the joy and teacher
Of a tribe of native heathen
In the land which gave her shelter.
And the tide of her affections
Flowed to those who gave her
 friendship;
Whom alone she knew as human,
Whom to her became as kindred.



FOOTNOTES:

[V] Literally, "first-born white daughter."

III

SAVAGE SORCERY

Man-to-ac, the Mighty Father,
When he filled the earth with
 blessings,
Deep within the heart of Woman
Hid the burning Need-of-Loving;
Which through her should warm the
 ages
With a flame of mutual feeling,
Throbbing through her sons and
 daughters
With a force beyond their power.
And this law of human loving,
Changeless through unending
 changes,
Fills each living heart with yearning
For another heart to love it;
And against this ceaseless craving
Creed, nor clime, nor color
 standeth;
Heart to heart all nature crieth
That the earth may thrill with
 gladness.

So the young braves of the nation,
Thrilled with love for fair Wi-no-na,
Made rude ornaments to please her,
Laid the red deer at her wigwam.
Brought her skins of furry rabbits
Soft and white as her own skin was;

Robbed the black bear and the otter
That her bed might soft and warm
be.

And the children of the forest
Were uplifted by such loving
Of a higher type of being,
Who yet throbbed with human
instincts.

Brave O-kis-ko loved the maiden
With a love which made him noble;
With the love that self-forgetting
Fills the soul with higher impulse.
As the sun with constant fervor,
Heat and light to earth bestowing,
Seeks for no return of blessing,
Feels no loss for all his giving,
So O-kis-ko loved Wi-no-na,
Gave her all his heart's rude
homage,
Felt no loss for all his giving,
Loved her for the joy of loving.
Scorned he all fatigue and danger
Which would bring her food or
pleasure;
And each day brought proof of
fealty,
For his deeds were more than
language.

For her sake he tried to fasten
To his rude canoe white pinions
Like the winged ships of the white
man,
That with her he might sail boldly
Out towards the rosy sunrise,
Seeking for her lost grandsire^[W]

For whose coming her heart
saddened.
Though his red companions mocked
him,
His endeavor pleased the maiden,
And her eyes beamed kindly on
him,
Though no passion stirred her
pulses.
For sweet maiden hopes and fancies
Filled her life with happy dreaming
Ere her woman's heart awakened
To O-kis-ko's patient waiting.
Waiting for her eyes to brighten
'Neath the ardor of his glances;
Waiting for her soul to quicken
With the answer to his longing;
Finding sweet content in silence,
Glad each day to see and serve her.

Now old Chi-co, the Magician,
Also loved the fair Wi-no-na,
All his youth to him returning
As he gazed upon her beauty.
In his wigwam pelt of gray wolf,
Antlers of the deer and bison,
Hung to prove his deeds of valor;
And he wooed the gentle maiden
With his cunning tales of prowess.

She would not rebuke his boasting,
Fearful lest her words offend him;
For her nature kind and loving
Could not scorn the vaunting Chi-
co.

When he walked among the
 maidens,
Gay with paint and decked with
 feathers,
She would look on him with
 kindness
That the others might not scoff him;
She would smile upon his
 weakness,
Though she did not wish to wed
 him.

Chi-co's love was fierce as fire
Which from flame yields only
 ashes;
Which gives not for joy of giving,
But demands unceasing tribute,
More and more to feed its craving.
He grew eager and impatient,
He would share with none her
 favor;
All for him her eyes must brighten,
Else his frown would blight her
 pleasure.

When the young men played or
 wrestled,
If O-kis-ko came out victor;
Or returning with the hunters
He it was who bore the stag home;
If with eyes abrim with pleasure
Sweet Wi-no-na smiled upon him,
Or with timid maiden shyness
Drooped her eyes beneath his
 glances,
Then old Chi-co's heart would
 wither

With the fire of jealous fury,
Till at length in bitter anger
He determined none should win her,
As from him she turned in coldness.

Wrapped in silence grim and sullen,
Much he wandered near the water;
With his soul he took dark counsel,
Seeking for devices cruel
For the torture of his rival
And destruction of the maiden.

Though he rarely used his power,
Chi-co was a great magician.
He knew all the spells of starlight
And the link 'tween moon and
 water;
Knew the language of lost spirits
And the secret of their power;
Knew the magic words and symbols
Whereby man may conquer nature.

Long he plotted,—much he
 brooded,
While he gathered from the water
Mussel-pearls all streaked and
 piedèd, [\[X\]](#)
All with rays like purple halos.

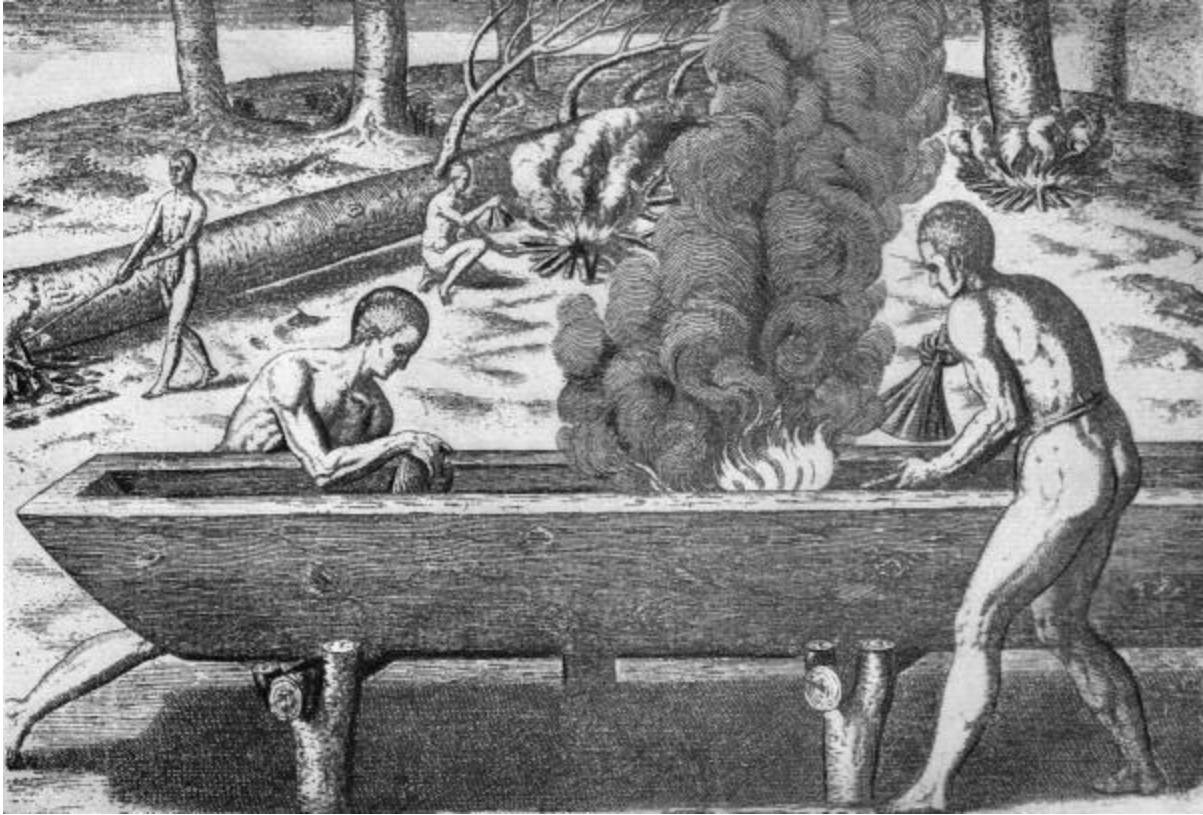
Such pearls are the souls of Naiads
Who have disobeyed the Sea-King,
And in mussel-shells are prisoned
For this taint of human frailty.
When by man released from
 durance
These souls, grateful for their
 freedom,

Are his slaves, and ever render
Good or evil at his bidding.

Chi-co steeped each one he gathered
In a bath of mystic brewing;
Told each purple, piedèd pearl-drop
What the evil was he plotted.
Never once his purpose wavered,
Never once his fury lessened;
Nursing vengeance as a guerdon
While the mussel-pearls he
polished.

Then a new canoe he fashioned,
Safe, and strong, and deep he made
it;^[Y]

And then sought to work his magic
On the innocent Wi-no-na;
Asked the maiden to go with him
In his boat across the water.
"Come," said he, "to Ro-a-no-ak,
Where the waves are white with
blossoms,
Where the grapes hang ripe in
clusters,
Come with me and drink their
juices."



"Then a new canoe he fashioned"

And the innocent Wi-no-na
Listened to his artful pleading;
Went with him in search of
 pleasure,
Glad to show him friendly feeling.

While with idle stroke they floated
To the fragrant lily-blossoms,
He a string of pearls gave to her,
Smooth and polished, pied and
 purple.
'Round her snowy neck she placed
 them
With no thought of harm or
 cunning;
And with simple, maiden speeches
Filled the time as they sped onward.

To each pearl had Chi-co chanted,
Each had bathed in mystic water,
Each held fast the same weird
 power,
Till the time grew ripe for evil.
On the waves they could not harm
 her,
There the Sea-King ruled them ever;
But when on the shore she landed
They would work their evil mission.

On the shore of Ro-a-no-ak
Chi-co sent his boat with vigor.
Lithe and happy she sprang
 shoreward,
When,—from where her foot first
 lightly
Pressed the sand with human
 imprint,—
On—away—towards the thicket,
Sprang *a White Doe*, fleet and
 graceful.

His revenge thus wrought in safety,
Drifting seaward Chi-co chanted:
"Go, White Doe, hide in the forest,
Feed upon the sweet wild-grasses;
No winged arrow e'er shall harm
 you,
No Red Hunter e'er shall win you;
Roam forever, fleet and fearless,
Living free and yet in fetters."

O fair maiden! born and nurtured
'Neath the shadow of disaster!
Isle of Fate was Ro-a-no-ak,
In the Land-of-Wind-and-Water.

Nevermore to fill with gladness
The sad heart of stricken mother;
Nevermore to hear the wooing
Of the brave and true O-kis-ko.
Gone thy charm of youthful beauty,
Gone thy sway o'er savage natures;
Doomed to flee before the hunter,
Doomed to roam the lonely island,
Doomed to bondage e'en in
 freedom.
Is the seal of doom eternal?
Hath the mussel-pearl all power?
Cannot *love* thy fetters loosen?



FOOTNOTES:

[W] Governor White, of the lost colony.

[X] See Appendix, Note [n](#).

[Y] See Appendix, Note [o](#).

IV

THE COUNTER-CHARM

Man-te-o and all his warriors
Long and far sought for Wi-no-na;
Sought to find the sky-eyed maiden
Sent by Man-to-ac, the Mighty,
To the Cro-a-to-ans to bless them,
And to make them wise and happy.
As a being more than mortal,
As a deity they held her;
And when no more seen among
 them
Lamentations filled the island.
Through Wo-ko-kon's sandy
 stretches,
Through the bog-lands of Po-mou-
 ik,
Even unto Das-a-mon-que-peu,
Hunted they the missing maiden;
If perchance some other nation,
Envious of their peace and plenty,
Had the maiden boldly captured,
For themselves to win her power.
Louder grew their lamentations
When they found no trail to follow;
Wilder grew their threats of
 vengeance
'Gainst the tribe which held her
 captive.

While they wailed the Pale-Face
Mother,
She who once was brave for love's
sake,
Weak from hardships new and
wearing,
Utterly bereft of kindred,
Her heart's comfort thus torn from
her,
Died beneath her weight of sorrow.
And a pity, soft and human,
Though he knew no name to call it,
Thrilled the Red Man as he laid her
'Neath the forest leaves to slumber.

But the wary, wily Chi-co
Told his secret unto no one,
While he listened to the stories,
Strange and true, told by the hunters
Of a fleet and graceful White Doe
On the banks of Ro-a-no-ak.
And the hunters said, no arrow
Howsoever aimed could reach her;
Said the deer herd round her
gathered,
And where e'er she led they
followed.

The old women of the nation
Heard the tales about this White
Doe.
Children they of superstition,
With their faith firm in
enchantment,
Linked the *going* of the maiden
With the *coming* of the White Doe.
They believed in magic powers,

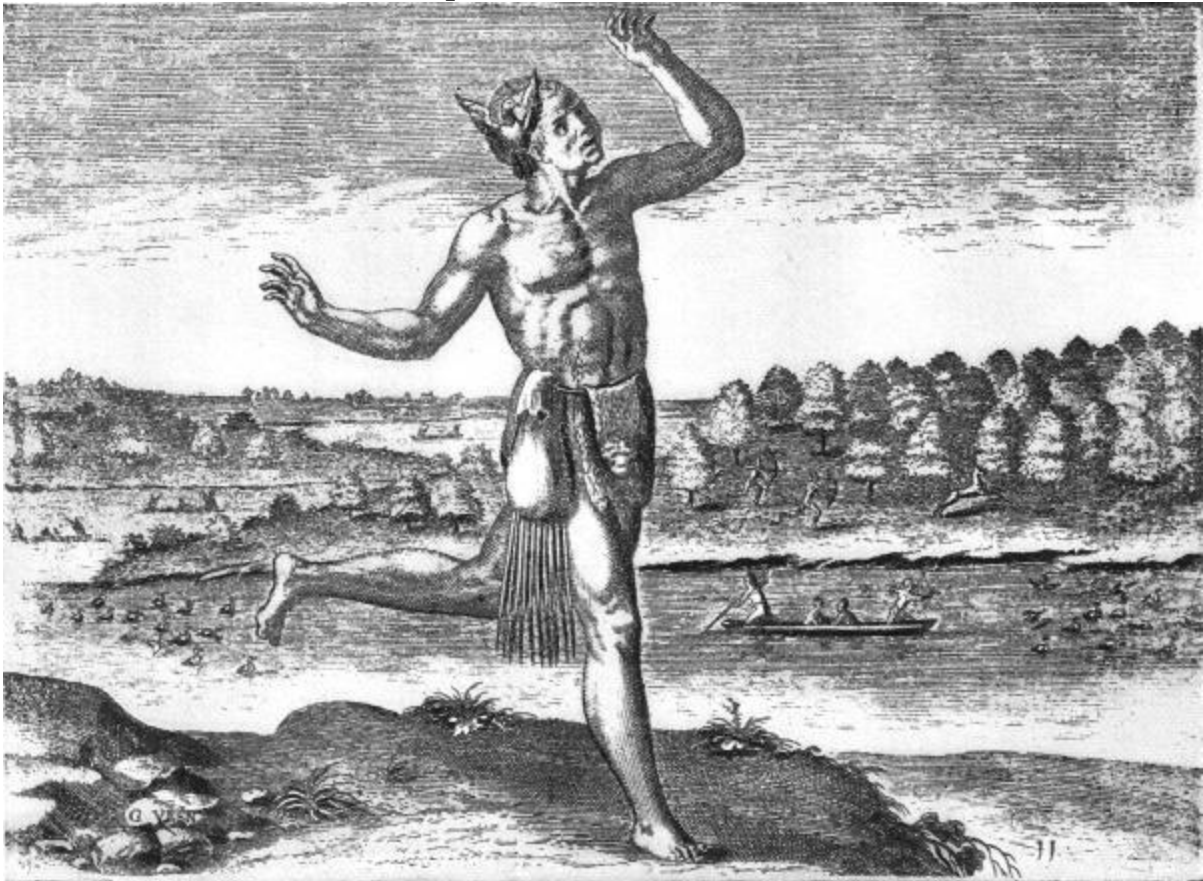
They knew Chi-co's hopeless
passion,
So they shook their heads and
whispered,
Looked mysterious at each other,
"Ho," they whispered to each other,
"Chi-co is a great Magician,
Chi-co should go hunt this White
Doe;
He is not too old for loving;
Love keeps step with Youth and
Courage;
Old age should not make him
tremble.
Timid is a doe, and gentle
Like a maiden,—like Wi-no-na.
Oho! Oho!" and they chuckled,
Casting dark looks at old Chi-co,
"He," said they, "has 'witched our
maiden."

When O-kis-ko heard the whispers
Of the garrulous old women,
Glad belief he gave unto them
That the Doe on Ro-a-no-ak
Was in truth the Pale-Face Maiden
Wrung from him by cruel magic.
He was not a gabbling boaster,
He could think and act in silence;
And alone he roamed the island
Seeking this White Doe to capture,
So that he might tame and keep her
Near him to assuage his sorrow.

All in vain,—no hand could touch
her.
All in vain,—no hunter won her.

Up the dunes of Ro-a-no-ak
Still she led the herd of wild deer.

Then O-kis-ko sought We-nau-don,
The Magician of Po-mou-ik.^[Z]
Gave him store of skins and
wampum,
Promised all his greed demanded,
If he would restore the maiden,
Break the spell which held her
spirit.



The magician of Po-mou-ik

In his heart We-nau-don cherished
Hatred for his rival Chi-co
For some boyhood's cause of anger,
For defeat in public wrestling;
And because of this he welcomed

Now the time to vent his malice.
So he promised from enchantment
To release the captive maiden.

In the days of pristine nature,
In the dells of Ro-a-no-ak,
Bubbling from the earth's dark
 caverns,
Was a spring of magic water.
There the Naiads held their revels,
There in secret met their lovers;
And they laid a spell upon it
Which should make true lovers
 happy;
For to them true love was precious.

He who drank of it at midnight
When the Harvest Moon was
 brightest,
Using as a drinking-vessel
Skull-bowl of his greatest rival
Killed in open, honest combat,
And by summer sunshine whitened,
He gained youth perennial from it
And the heart he wished to love
 him.

He who bathed within its waters,
Having killed a dove while
 moaning,
And had killed no other creature
Since three crescent moons had
 rounded;
Vowing to be kind and helpful
To the sad and weary-hearted:
He received the magic power
To undo all spells of evil

Which divided faithful lovers.

In this spring had bathed We-nau-
don,

And he held its secrets sacred;
But a feeling ever moved him
To make glad the heavy-hearted.
So he showed unto O-kis-ko
Where to find the magic water;
With this counter-charm, he told
him

How to free the charmed Wi-no-na:

"In a shark's tooth, long and narrow
In a closely wrought triangle,
Set three mussel-pearls of purple,
Smooth and polished with much
rubbing.

To an arrow of witch-hazel,
New, and fashioned very slender,
Set the shark's tooth, long and
narrow,

With its pearl-inlaid triangle.
From the wing of living heron
Pluck one feather, white and trusty;
With this feather wing the arrow,
That it swerve not as it flyeth.
Fashioned thus with care and
caution,

Let no mortal eye gaze on it;
Tell no mortal of your purpose;
Secretly at sunset place it
In the spring of magic water.
Let it rest there through three
sunsets,

Then when sunrise gilds the tree-
tops

Take it dripping from the water,
At the rising sun straight point it,
While three times these words
 repeating:
Mussel-pearl arrow, to her heart
 go;
Loosen the fetters which bind the
 White Doe;
Bring the lost maiden back to O-kis-
 ko.

With this arrow hunt the White Doe,
Have no timid fear of wounding;
When her heart it enters boldly
Chi-co's charm will melt before it."

Every word O-kis-ko heeded,
Hope, once dead, now cheered his
 spirit.
From the sea three pearls he
 gathered;
From the thicket brought witch-
 hazel
For the making of the arrow;
From the heron's wing a feather
Plucked to true its speed in flying.
Patiently he cut and labored,
As for love's sake man will labor;
Shaped the arrow, new and slender,
Set the pearls into the shark's tooth,
Fastened firm the heron's feather,
With a faith which mastered reason.
In the magic spring he steeped it,
Watching lest some eye should see
 it;
Through three sunsets steeped and
 watched it;
Three times o'er the charm repeated

While the sunrise touched the tree-
tops;
Then prepared to test its power.



FOOTNOTES:

[\[Z\]](#) See Appendix, Note [s](#).



V

THE HUNT

In the Land-of-Wind-and-Water
Long the Summer-Glory lingered,
Loath to yield its ripened beauty
To the cold embrace of Winter.
And the greenness of the forest
Gave no sign of coming treason,
Till the White Frost without
 warning
Hung his banners from the tree-
 tops.
Then a blush of brilliant color
Decked each shrub with tinted
 beauty;
Gold, and brown, and scarlet
 mingled
Till no color seemed triumphant;
And the Summer doomed to exile
Fled before the chilling Autumn.

While the glow of colors deepened,
The proud Weroance Win-gin-a,
Chief of Das-a-mon-gue-pue land,
Made a feast for all his people;
Called them forth with bow and
 arrow
To a test of skill and valor.
He was weary of the mysteries
Whispered of the famous White
 Doe,

Whose strange courage feared no
hunter,
For no arrow ever reached her.
"Ha!" said he, "a skilful hunter
Is not daunted by a white doe;
Craven hearts make trembling
fingers,
Arrows fail when shot by cowards.
I will shoot this doe so fearless,
Her white skin shall be my mantle,
[\[AA\]](#)

Her white meat shall serve for
feasting,
And my braves shall cease from
fearing.
From the fields the maize invites us,
Sturgeons have been fat and plenty.
We are weary of fish-eating,
We will feast on meat of white
deer."

Messengers of invitation
Sent he to the other nations,
Saying, "Come and hunt the White
Doe,
Bring your surest, fleetest arrows;
We will eat the meat of white deer,
We will drink the purple grape-
juice,
Burn the uppowoc in pipe-bowls,
While we shame the trembling
hunters."

But the Cro-a-to-ans kept silence,
Sent no answer to his greeting.
They believed the charmèd White
Doe

Was Wi-no-na Skâ's pure spirit,
Who in freedom still was happy,
And they would not wound or harm
her,
They would shoot no arrows at her,
Nor help feast upon her body.

Then O-kis-ko answered boldly;
"I will go and hunt this White Doe,
I will shoot from my own ambush,
I will take my fleetest arrow."
And the men and women wondered,
For they knew his former loving.

But O-kis-ko kept his secret,
Showed no one his new-made
arrow;
'Round his shoulders threw a mantle
Made of skins of many sea-gulls,
So that he could hide his arrow,
And no mortal eye could see it
Till he sent it on its mission
Winged with magic, fraught with
mercy.

Thus he went to Ro-a-no-ak,
Love, and hope, and faith impelling,
Conscious of his aim unerring,
Trusting in the arrow's power.

From Po-mou-ik came Wan-ches-e,
For the hunt and feast impatient,
Boasting of his skill and valor,
Saying in his loud vainglory:
"I will teach the braves to shoot
deer,
Young men now are not great
hunters,

Hearts like squaws they have within
 them,
Nothing fears them but a papoose."

Wan-ches-e had crossed the
 water^[AB]
In the ships with wings like sea-
 birds,
And the Pale-Face Weroanza,
Whom he saw in her own country,
Him to please and show her
 friendship,
Gave an arrow-head of silver
To him as a mark of favor.

This he now brought proudly with
 him,
As of all his arrows fleetest;
Bearing in its lustrous metal,
As he thought, some gift of power
From the mighty Weroanza
Which would bring success unto
 him;
And the warriors all would praise
 him
As around the feast they gathered,
Saying as he walked among them:
"There is none like brave Wan-ches-
 e,
He can bend the bow with firmness,
He has arrow-points of silver,
And the White Doe falls before
 him."
And he polished well the arrow
Which he thought would bring him
 praises.

Where the deer were wont to
wonder
All the hunters took their stations,
While the stalkers sought the forest,
From its depths to start the deer-
herd.

Near the shore Win-gin-a lingered
That he first might shoot his arrow,
And thus have the certain glory
Of the White Doe's death upon him.

By a pine-tree stood Wan-ches-e
With his silver arrow ready;
While O-kis-ko, unseen, waited
Near by in his chosen ambush,
Where he oft had watched the White
Doe,
Where he knew she always
lingered.

Soon the stalkers with great
shouting
Started up the frightened red deer;
On they came through brake and
thicket,
In the front the White Doe leading,
With fleet foot and head uplifted,
Daring all the herd to follow.

Easy seemed the task of killing,
So Win-gin-a twanged his bow-
string,
But his arrow fell beside her
As she sprang away from danger.

Through the tanglewood, still
onward,

Head uplifted, her feet scorning
All the wealth of bright-hued
 foliage
Which lay scattered in her pathway.
Up the high sand-dunes she
 bounded,
In her wake the whole herd
 followed,
While the arrows aimed from
 ambush
Fell around her ever harmless.

On she sped, towards the water,
Nostrils spread to sniff the sea-
 breeze;
Through the air a whizzing arrow
Flew, but did not touch the White
 Doe;
But a stag beside her bounding
Wounded fell among the bushes,
And the herd fled in confusion,
Waiting now not for the leader.

On again, with leaping footsteps,
Tossing head turned to the sea-
 shore;
For one fatal minute standing
Where the White Man's Fort had
 once stood;
In her eyes came wistful gleamings
Like a lost hope's fleeting shadow.

While with graceful poise she
 lingered,
Swift, Wan-ches-e shot his arrow
Aimed with cruel thought to kill
 her;

While from near and secret ambush,
With unerring aim, O-kis-ko
Forward sent his magic arrow,
Aimed with thought of love and
mercy.

To her heart straight went *both*
arrows,
And with leap of pain she bounded
From the earth, and then fell
forward,
Prone, amidst the forest splendor.
O-kis-ko, with fond heart swelling,
Wan-ches-e, with pride exultant,
To the Doe both sprang to claim it,
Each surprised to see the other.

Suddenly, within the forest,
Spread a gleaming mist around
them,
Like a dense white fog in summer,
So they scarce could grope their
pathway.
Slowly, as if warmed by sunbeams,
From one spot the soft mist melted,
While within its bright'ning
dimness,
With the misty halo 'round her,
Stood a beautiful white maiden,—
Stood the gentle, lost Wi-no-na.

Through her heart two arrows
crosswise
Pierced the flesh with cruel
wounding;
Downward flowed the crimson
blood-tide,

Staining red the snow-white doe-
skin
Which with grace her form
enveloped,
While her arms with pleading
gesture
To O-kis-ko were outstretching.

As they gazed upon the vision,
All their souls with wonder filling;
While the white mist slowly melted,
Prostrate fell the wounded maiden.

Then revealed was all the myst'ry,
Then they saw what had befallen.
To her heart the magic arrow
First had pierced, and lo! Wi-no-na
Once more breathed in form of
maiden.

But while yet the charm was
passing
Came the arrow of Wan-ches-e;
To her heart it pierced unerring,
Pierced the pearl-inlaid triangle,
Struck and broke the shark's tooth
narrow,
Charm and counter-charm undoing;
Leaving but a mortal maiden
Wounded past the hope of healing.

Woe to love, and hope, and magic!
Woe to hearts whom death divideth!
While upon her bleeding bosom
Fatal arrows made the Cross-Sign,
Wistful eyes she turned to Heaven;
"O forget not your Wi-no-na,"
Whispered she unto O-kis-ko,

As her soul passed to the silence.

FOOTNOTES:

[[AA](#)] See Appendix, Note [p](#).

[[AB](#)] See Appendix, Note [l](#).

VI

THE SILVER ARROW

Fear seized on the bold Wan-ches-e
When he saw the Pale-Face maiden
Standing where had poised the
White Doe,

Where the White Man's Fort had
once stood.

He knew naught of magic arrows,
Nor O-kis-ko's secret mission;
He saw only his own arrow
Piercing through her tender bosom,
Never doubting but the wonder
Which his awe-struck eyes had
witnessed

Had been wrought by his own
arrow,

Silver arrow from a far land,
Fashioned by the skill of Pale-Face,
Gift of Pale-Face Weroanza
To a race she willed to conquer.

All his hatred of the Pale-Face,
Fed by fear and superstition,
To him made this sudden vision
Seem an omen of the future,
When the Red Man, like the White
Doe,
Should give place unto the Pale-
Face,
And the Indian, like the white mist,

Fade from out his native forest.
All his courage seemed to weaken
With the dread of dark disaster;
And with instincts strong for safety
Fled he from the place in terror.

Love hath not the fear of danger,
And O-kis-ko's faith in magic
Kept him brave to meet the changes
Which had each so quickly
followed.

For he saw the human maiden
Where had stood the living White
Doe;
And he knew his hazel arrow,
Charmed with all We-nau-don's
magic,
Had restored the lost Wi-no-na
To reward his patient loving.

But the conflict of *two* arrows,
Bringing death unto the maiden,
Was a deep and darksome myst'ry
Which his ignorance could not
fathom.

All the cause of his undoing
Saw he in the silver arrow;
So with true love's tireless effort,
Quick he strove to break its power.

From her heart he plucked the
arrow,
Hastened to the magic water,
Hoping to destroy the evil
Which had stilled the maiden's
pulses.
In the sparkling spring he laid it

So no spot was left uncovered,
So the full charm of the water
Might act on the blood-stained
arrow.

As the blood-stains from it melted,
Blood of Pale-Face shed by Red
Man,
Slowly, while he watched and
waited,
All the sparkling water vanished;
Dry became the magic fountain,
Leaving bare the silver arrow.

Was it thus the spell would weaken
Which had wrought his love such
evil?
Would she be again awakened
When he sought her in the thicket?
Must he shoot this arrow at her
To restore her throbbing pulses?
Must he seek again We-nau-don
To make warm her icy beauty?

While he of himself sought
guidance,
Sought to know the hidden meaning
Of the mysteries he witnessed;
Lo! another mystic wonder
Met his eyes as he sat musing.

From the arrow made by Pale-Face,
As th' enchanted water left it,
Sprang a tiny shoot with leaflets
Pushing upward to the sunlight.

Did the arrow dry the fountain
With the blight of death it carried?

Or in going, had the water
Left a charm upon the arrow?
Did the heart-blood of the Pale-Face
From the arrow in the water
Cause the coming of the green
 shoot,
Which reached upward to the
 sunlight?

All O-kis-ko's love and courage
Could not give him greater
 knowledge.
Savage mind could not unravel
All the meaning of this marvel.
Fear forbade him touch the arrow
Lest he should destroy the green
 shoot;
So he left the tender leaflets
Reaching upward to the sunlight,
Sought again the lifeless maiden
For whose love his soul had
 hungered;
Knelt beside her in the forest,
With the awe of death upon him,
Which in heathen as in Christian
Moves the human soul to worship.

All his faith in savage magic
Turned to frenzy at his failure;
And the helplessness of mortals
Pressed upon him like a burden;
While a mighty longing seized him
For a knowledge of the Unknown,
For a light to pierce the Silence
Into which none enter living.
And unconsciously his spirit
Rose in quest of Might Supernal,

Which should rule both dead and
 living,
Leaving naught to chance or magic;
Which should seize the throbbing
 pulses
Ebbing from a dying mortal,
And create a higher being
Free from thrall of earthly nature;
Almost grasping in his yearning
Knowledge of the God Eternal,
In whose hand the earth lies
 helpless,
In whose heart all souls find refuge.

But no light came to O-kis-ko;
Still the burden pressed upon him,
And a pall of hopeless yearning
Wrapped his soul in voiceless
 sorrow
As he gazed upon the maiden
With death's mysteries enfolded.
Then he made upon her bosom
The strange Cross-Sign she had
 taught him;
From his shoulders took the mantle
Made of skins of many sea-gulls,
Gently wrapped the maiden in it,
Heaped the tinted leaves about her;
Leaving all his own life's brightness
With her where the shadows
 darkened.

Thus the ancient legend runneth, with its
 plaint of hopeless doom,
Bearing in its heart the fragrance of the
 Truth's enduring bloom,
Standing in the light of knowledge, where
 developed ages meet,
We can read the mystic omens which O-
 kis-ko's eyes did greet.
And to us they seem the symbols of what
 coming ages brought,
Realization gives the answer, which in vain
 the Savage sought.
For we know the silver arrow, fatal to all
 sorcery,
Was the gleaming light of Progress
 speeding from across the sea,
Before which the Red Man vanished,
 shrinking from its silvery light
As the magic waters yielded to the silver
 arrow's blight.
And the tiny shoot with leaflets, by the
 sunlight warmed to life,
Was the Vine of Civilization in the
 wilderness of strife;
With no friendly hand to tend it, yet it grew
 midst slight and wrong,
Taking root in other places, ^[AC]—growing
 green, and broad, and strong,
Till its vigor knew no weakness, with its
 branches flower-fraught,
Till a prosp'rous land it sheltered where th'
 oppressed a refuge sought,
Till its fruit made all who labored 'neath its
 shade both bold and free,
Till a people dwelt beneath it strong to
 meet their destiny.

Now beneath its spreading branches dwells
a nation brave and free,
Raising glad, triumphant pæans for the
boon of Liberty;
Holding fast the Holy Cross-Sign,—Heirs
of Duty and of Light,—
Still they speed the arrow, Progress, on its
civilizing flight;
Keeping bright the Fires of Freedom, where
Man, Brotherhood may know,
For God's breath upon the altar keeps the
sacred flame aglow.



FOOTNOTES:

[\[AC\]](#) Jamestown and Plymouth Rock.



APPENDIX

NOTE *a.*—"We viewed the land about us, being where we first landed very sandy and low towards the water side, but so full of grapes as the very beating and surge of the sea overflowed them, of which we found such plenty, as well there as in all places else, both on the sand and on the green soil, on the hills as in the plains, as well on every little shrub, as also climbing towards the tops of high cedars, that I think in all the world the like abundance is not to be found."—*First voyage of Amadas and Barlowe, 1584. From Hakluyt.*

NOTE *b.*—"The second of July we found shoal water, where we smelled so sweet and so strong a smell as if we had been in the midst of some delicate garden abounding with all kinds of odoriferous flowers, by which we were assured that the land could not be far distant."—*First voyage of Amadas and Barlowe, 1584.*

NOTE *c.*—"Deer, in some places there are great store: near unto the seacoast they are of the ordinary bigness of ours in England, and some less: but further up into the country where there is better feed, they are greater."—*Harriot's Report.*

NOTE *d.*—"The Governor (John White) with divers of his company, walked to the north end of the island, where Master Ralph Lane had his fort, with sundry necessary and decent dwelling houses, made by his men about it, the year before, where we hoped to find some signs, or certain knowledge of our fifteen men. When we came thither we found the fort razed down, but all the houses standing unhurt, saving that the neather rooms of them, and also of the fort, were overgrown with melons of divers sorts, and deer within them, feeding on those melons; so we returned to our company, without hope of ever seeing any of the fifteen alive."—*Hakluyt.*

NOTE *e.*—"At our first landing they seemed as though they would fight with us, but perceiving us begin to march with our shot towards them, they turned their backs and fled. Then Manteo, their countryman, called to them in their own language, whom, as soon as they heard, they returned, and

threw away their bows and arrows, and some of them came unto us embracing and entertaining us friendly, desiring us not to gather or spoil any of their corn, for that they had but little. We answered them that neither their corn nor any other thing of theirs should be diminished by any of us, and that our coming was only to renew the old love, that was between us and them at the first, and to live with them as brethren and friends; which answer seemed to please them well, wherefore they requested us to walk up to their town, who there feasted us after their manner, and desired us earnestly *that there might be some token or badge given them of us*, whereby we might know them to be our friends," etc.

"And also we understood by them of Croatoan, how that the fifteen Englishmen left at Roanoak the year before, by Sir Richard Grenville, were suddenly set upon by thirty of the men of Secota, Aquoscogoc, and Dasamonguepeuc, in manner following. They conveyed themselves secretly behind the trees, near the houses where our men carelessly lived, and having perceived that of those fifteen they could see but eleven only, two of those savages appeared to the eleven Englishmen, calling to them by friendly signs that but two of their chief men should come unarmed to speak with those two savages, who seemed also to be unarmed. Wherefore two of the chiefest of our Englishmen went gladly to them; but whilst one of those savages traitorously embraced one of our men, the other with his sword of wood, which he had secretly hidden under his mantle, struck him on the head and slew him, and presently the other eight and twenty savages shewed themselves; the other Englishman perceiving this, fled to his company, whom the savages pursued with their bows and arrows so fast that the Englishmen were forced to take the house, wherein all their victuals and weapons were; but the savages forthwith set the same on fire, by means whereof our men were forced to take up such weapons as came first to hand, and without order to run forth among the savages, with whom they skirmished above an hour. In this skirmish another of our men was shot into the mouth with an arrow, where he died; and also one of the savages was shot into the side by one of our men, with a wild fire arrow, whereof he died presently. The place where they fought was of great advantage to the savages, by means of the thick trees, behind which the savages through their nimbleness defended themselves, and so offended our men with their arrows, that our men, being some of them hurt, retired fighting to the water

side where their boat lay, with which they fled towards Hatorask. By that time they had rowed but a quarter of a mile, they espied their four fellows coming from a creek thereby, where they had been to fetch oysters; these four they received into their boat, leaving Roanoak, and landed on a little island on the right hand of our entrance into the harbor of Hatorask, where they remained awhile, but afterwards departed, whither as yet we know not."—*Hakluyt*.

NOTE *f*.—"The thirteenth of August, our savage, Manteo, by the commandment of Sir Walter Raleigh, was christened in Roanoak, and called Lord thereof, and of Dasamonguepeuc, in reward of his faithful services."—*Hakluyt*.

NOTE *g*.—"The eighteenth, Eleanor, daughter to the Governor, and wife to Ananias Dare, one of the assistants, was delivered of a daughter, in Roanoak, and the same was christened there the Sunday following, and because this child was the first Christian born in Virginia, she was named Virginia."—*Hakluyt*.

NOTE *h*.—"The twenty-second of August, the whole company, both of the assistants and planters, came to the Governor, and with one voice requested him to return himself into England, for the better and sooner obtaining of supplies and other necessities for them; but he refused it, and alleged many sufficient causes why he would not.... The next day, not only the assistants, but divers others, as well women as men, began to renew their requests to the Governor again, to take upon him to return into England for the supplies and dispatch of all such things as there were to be done.... The Governor being at the last, through their extreme entreating, constrained to return into England, having then but half a day's respite to prepare himself for the same, departed from Roanoak the seven and twentieth of August in the morning, and the same day about midnight came aboard the Fly-boat who already had weighed anchor, and rode without the bar, the admiral riding by them, who but the same morning was newly come thither again. The same day both the ships weighed anchor and set sail for England."—*Hakluyt*.

NOTE *k*.—"Our boats and all things filled again, we put off from Hatorask, being the number of nineteen persons in both boats; but before we could get to the place where our planters were left, it was so exceeding dark, that we

overshot the place a quarter of a mile, where we espied towards the North end of the island the light of a great fire through the woods to the which we presently rowed: when we came right over against it we let fall our grapnel near the shore, and sounded with a trumpet a call, and afterwards many familiar English tunes of songs, and called to them friendly; but we had no answer, we therefore landed at daybreak, and coming to the fire we found the grass and sundry rotten trees burning about the place. From hence we went through the woods to that part of the island directly over against Dasamonguepeuc, and from thence we returned by the water side round about the north point of the island, until we came to the place where I left our colony in the year 1586. In all this way we saw in the sand the print of the savages' feet of two or three sorts trodden in the night; and as we entered up the sandy bank, upon a tree, in the very brow thereof, were curiously carved these fair Roman letters C. R. O., which letters presently we knew to signify the place where I should find the planters seated, according to a secret token agreed upon between them and me at my last departure from them; which was, that in any way they should not fail to write or carve on the trees or posts of the doors the name of the place where they should be seated; for at my coming away they were prepared to remove from Roanoak fifty miles into the main. Therefore at my departure from them in An. 1587, I willed them that if they should happen to be distressed in any of those places, that then they should carve over the letters or name, a cross † in this form; but we found no such sign of distress.... And having well considered of this, we passed towards the place where they were left in sundry houses, but we found the houses taken down, and the place very strongly enclosed with a high palisade of great trees, with curtains and flankers, very fort-like, and one of the chief trees or posts at the right side of the entrance had the bark taken off, and five feet from the ground in fair capital letters was graven CROATOAN without any cross or sign of distress.... I greatly joyed that I had safely found a certain token of their safe being at Croatoan, which is the place where Manteo was born, and the savages of the island our friends."—*From Governor White's account of his voyage in search of the colonists, after the defeat of the Spanish Armada. Hakluyt, Vol. III.*

NOTE I.—"We brought home also two of the savages, being lusty men, whose names were Wan-ches-e and Man-te-o."—*First voyage by Amadas*

and Barlowe.

NOTE *m.*—All authorities agree in the statement that the favorite time among the Indians for an attack on an enemy was at, or about, daybreak.

NOTE *n.*—"Into this river falls another great river called Cipo in which there is found great store of mussels in which there are pearls."—*Voyage of Amadas and Barlowe.*

"In her ears she had bracelets of pearls, hanging down to her middle, and these were of the bigness of good pease."—*Voyage of Amadas and Barlowe.*

"Sometimes feeding on mussels, we found some pearle, but it was our hap to meet with ragges, or of a pied colour; not having yet discovered those places where we heard of better and more plenty."—*Harriot's Report.*

NOTE *o.*—"The manner of making their boats in Virginia is very wonderful. For whereas they want instruments of iron or others like unto ours, yet they know how to make them as handsomely, to sail with where they list in their rivers, and to fish withal, as ours. First they choose some long and thick tree, according to the bigness of the boat which they would frame, and make a fire on the ground about the roots thereof, kindling the same by little and little with dry moss of trees, and chips of wood that the flame should not mount up too high, and burn too much of the length of the tree. When it is almost burnt through, and ready to fall they make a new fire which they suffer to burn until the tree falls of its own accord. Then burning off the top and boughs of the tree in such wise that the body of the same may retain his just length, they raise it upon poles laid over cross wise upon forked posts at such a reasonable height as they may handsomely work upon it. Then take they off the bark with certain shells; they reserve the innermost part of the bark for the nethermost part of the boat. On the other side they make a fire according to the length of the body of the tree saving at both the ends. That which they think is sufficiently burned, they quench and scrape away with shells, and making a new fire they burn it again and so they continue, sometimes burning and sometimes scraping until the boat have sufficient bottoms."—*Harriot's Report.*

NOTE *p.*—"They are a people clothed with loose mantles made of deer skin, and aprons of the same round about their middles."—*Harriot's Report.*

NOTE s.—"They have commonly conjurers or jugglers, which use strange gestures, and often contrary to nature in their enchantments: For they be very familiar with devils of whom they inquire what their enemies do, or other such things."—*Harriot's Report*.

Transcriber's Notes

Page [xiii](#): Changed thay to that
(Tradition relates thay they transplanted this vine).

Spelling variations:

Page [55](#): Das-a-mon-que-peu

Page [63](#): Das-a-mon-gue-pue

Pages [83](#), [84](#), [86](#): Dasamonguepeuc

Pages [xii](#), [xiv](#): Hariot

[Appendix](#) Notes: Harriot

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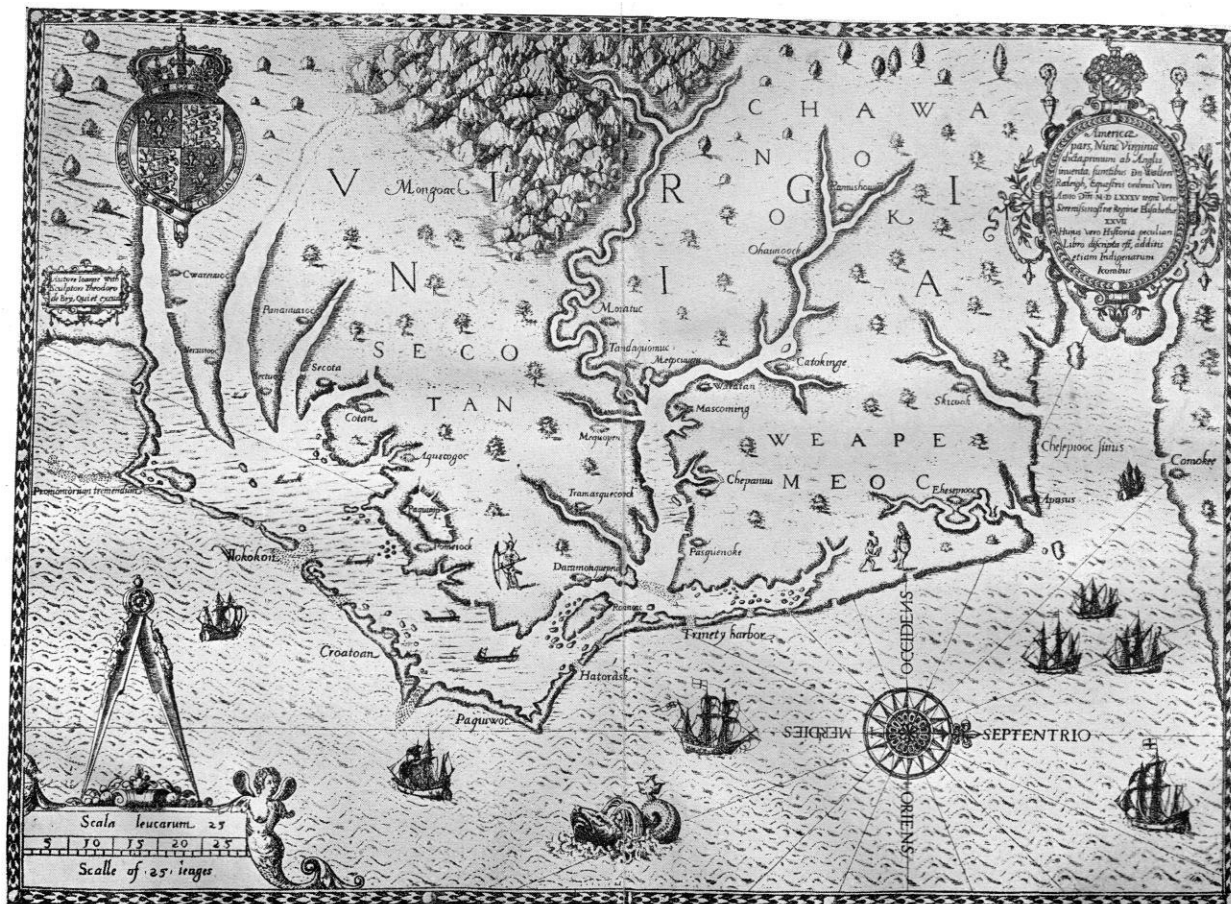
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